

INTERNATIONAL SLED DOG RACING ASSOCIATION, INC.

THE ISDRA RACE MANUAL



This manual is intended to help race-sponsoring organizations to produce and promote sled dog races which will be rewarding to all concerned persons, including the sponsors, the contestants, the spectators and media representative and in turn, encourage the popularity of the sport. Some of the sections have been updated since the original printing in 1971, but some of the information will appear to be dated as to mention of production costs, race references, etc. In these areas, the information is still valid but the reader should take into consideration prevailing conditions.

The International Sled Dog Racing Association, Inc. is a non-profit organization committed to the standardization of sled dog events which foster the preservation and well-being of sled dogs as working and racing athletes in their finest traditions.

INTRODUCTION

The reader will notice that the Race Manual is a large book which seems to contain much more information than he is able to absorb in a single reading. It is inevitable that such a book would become lengthy if all the material submitted by more than a dozen experienced contributors was included. After considerable thought and discussion, it was decided to go ahead and use all of the information. The apparently trivial detail may solve a vexing problem that could influence the future of a race.

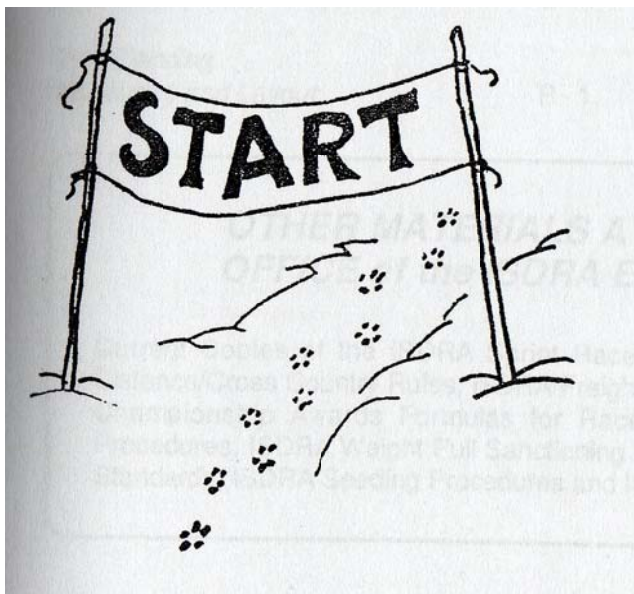
The words, "sponsor," "club" and "organization" are often used interchangeably throughout these pages. Sometimes, they should be interpreted as meaning the "individuals" putting on the race. Sometimes, they should be read as the "person" in charge of this entire department. "Organization" and "club" often refers to the managers/producers of the actual race; "sponsor" may be interpreted the same way but can refer to the financial backer of the race, often a company seeking positive exposure for its product or service.

Most chapters contain details and suggestions that would be of interest only to those planning a classic/championship caliber race. The persons responsible for performing the various tasks connected with producing a sled dog race must realize that certain methods and plans are useful only when they can be efficiently carried out by a well-mannered staff. Ascertain what you can do, then do the best you can within the limits you have set. Don't set your standards too high for the experience and ability available within your organization.

Several subjects which overlap are included within more than one chapter/section in this book. Refer to the Table of Contents for the main headings of area which are of particular concern to you but to gain a complete overview of production procedures, a general reading of the book from cover to cover can be helpful.

Ideally, each committee chairman within a race-giving club should possess a copy of the ISDRA Race Manual. In any case, the secretary of the organization, or the race manager, should have a complete cope at all times. Individual pages concerning the various duties of persons involved in the promotion and production of a sled dog event may be removed for a copying and for distribution to key personnel.

The following persons contributed to the creation of the ISDRA Race Manual which is still being used by sled dog organizations as a guidebook in the production of quality sled dog events.



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OTHER MATERIALS AVAILABLE through the OFFICE of the ISDRA EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Current Copies of the ISDRA Sprint Race Rules, ISDRA Weight Pull Rules, ISDRA Long Distance/Cross Country Rules, ISDRA Freight Race Rules, ISDRA Gig Race Rules, ISDRA Point Championship Awards Formulas for Races and Weight Pulls, ISDRA Race Sanctioning Procedures, ISDRA Weight Pull Sanctioning Procedures, ISDRA Sanctioning Requirements and Standards, ISDRA Seeding Procedures and ISDRA Drug Control Procedures.

Advisors: Tim Trowbridge
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PLANNING WITHIN THE CLUB

So you have a club that wants to put on a race! It sounds so simple, but you will be amazed at how much is involved. Only with extensive pre-planning will a good race actually happen. Your club will need to become fully organized with specific duties given to the various active members prior to even contacting potential sponsors. It has been proven unwise for assorted individuals to go to different organizations on their own, without any procedure in mind because local businessmen's groups and clubs do compare notes. It is possible to discourage any group from supporting a race simply by contacting too many and giving conflicting promises to each. "Working together", where possible, is advisable. The purpose of this chapter and the next are to provide you with some suggested procedures that have worked for some clubs. You will have to adapt them to your specific club and situation.

Before contacting a sponsor, the club should have experience in running a "Fun Race" or Preliminary Race. This can easily be done in the spring and fall training seasons with wheel rigs. Race conditions should be approximated as closely as possible, with a Race Marshall going over the rules at the mushers' meeting, a drawing for starting positions, an interval start, trail markers, helpers spotted on the trail and accurate timing. Members of the club who do not have teams can help out on the trail and help in handling dogs at the starting line. If possible, a PA system and announcer should be used even if the announcer is talking to only 15 people and 20 dogs. What you want to do is to give maximum experience to dogs, drivers and race officials.

Now that the club members are educated so they understand the basic workings of the race, the club will have a better idea of what it wants to do. The North Star Sled Dog Club of Minnesota sets goals for itself for the winter season. These goals are posted on large placards in the club meeting room for all to see and be reminded of what they voted to try to do. Your club may decide to concentrate on one good small race the first year, or one big race and several smaller ones, or a two day race every weekend in January and February. It is also wise to decide how large a purse to ask for. Great Lakes Sled Dog Association found that sponsors had talked to each other and then asked GLSDA how come one sponsor got a race for \$300 while another had to pay \$600! The club should determine minimum purse events, such as \$300 for a one day first year race and \$500 thereafter; and \$1000 the minimum for a two day race. These are the figures adopted by the Wisconsin Trailblazers Sled Dog Club and are mentioned as a guide line.

Be sure that your club and potential sponsors know the difference between an established major event and a first time sled dog race. You can point out that prize money beyond the minimum will bring a larger entry. Whatever you decide as far as the number of races and their size, be realistic - how many members do you have, how many teams, how much experience, and who can be depended upon to do the work? Of course your goals should be a challenge and a near unanimity of opinion should be achieved.

You will need to determine at the outset how much your club can do in running the race. Generally, the more your club can do the better, simply because of your interest and knowledge of the sport. If you have to depend upon the sponsor for the PA and the announcer, you can also depend upon the system breaking down at least once. If your club has a PA and announcer, hopefully the announcer thought to bring along tools to repair the thing. The club's announcer would also be able to distinguish between a team of Samoyeds and a team of hounds for the enlightenment of the spectators. Unless the sponsor is thoroughly trained in handling dogs, club members serving as spotters out of the trail will be superior. **OBVIOUSLY THE TRAIL CAN ONLY BE LAID OUT AND MARKED UNDER THE DIRECTION OF A CLUB MEMBER - PREFERABLY AN EXPERIENCED DRIVER.**

In determining what the club can do and what should be left up to the sponsor; the rule is: Do as much as you can of what you can do best. Sale of concessions, race programs, parking, local advertising, publicity and crowd control are best left up to the sponsor as areas he can handle best. If your club does not have the dependable spare manpower to serve as spotters on the trail, PA announcers, handlers, trail markers, judges, and timers, you will have to depend on the sponsor to furnish these people. But don't expect much of a job to be done by the inexperienced.

Once you have an idea of how many and how big races you want to have and how much your club can do, you need to draw up a contract. The purpose of the contract is to set forth the responsibilities of the club and the sponsor. (See example on page C-1). Be sure that this is written and signed in duplicate with one copy for the sponsor and the other retained by the club. You may be surprised at the difference between what the sponsor will verbally promise and what he is actually willing to sign. You will be even more surprised if 30 teams show up on race day for a verbally promised purse of \$500 and the winners divide 500 pounds of the cheapest dog food around! (It has happened.)

Be sure that all club members know what the race contract says - what responsibilities the club has and what responsibilities the sponsor has. Now a Race Co-ordinator (or club officer so designated) is needed. This person is the only one authorized by the club to sign the contract. This person needs to know what is going on in the club and in nearby clubs. He can advise as to what dates would be best to complement other race dates, both within the club and without, and make sure that there are not two races scheduled on the same day, 20 miles apart. The Race Co-ordinator will have to work closely with other clubs and with individual race chairmen so that he will have some idea of the number of teams that might be expected at the race. Sponsors always want to know how many teams will come. Always give a very conservative minimum. If they are guaranteed fifteen teams and thirty show up, the sponsor will be twice as happy, figuring he got double his money's worth. You want to be invited back next year with a bigger purse, so don't over sell.

Advisors: Tim Trowbridge
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PLANNING WITH THE SPONSOR

Now that the club has its planning done, you are ready to think about the sponsor. Basically you want the sponsor to put up the purse and an area for trail. Your club will provide entertainment and possible income for the locality.

Who Are Potential Sponsors?

The Only Organization in the Area. If a growing racing club wishes to obtain sponsorship from a single group, because of its success with other events, or its advantages for publicity and physical help, the club has little choice but to present its ideas to the organization that is dominant in the area, is known to have financial backing, and has a large, active membership.

The following will generally disqualify an organization as a potential sponsor:

1. Currently sponsoring another established event, not associated with winter sports, at the same time of the year.
2. Devoted to another sport, ie: snowmobile clubs seldom welcome participation by dog racers and are seldom willing to help out financially or otherwise.
3. Mostly composed of older people, as retired persons' club, religious organization.

In the event that the only solvent organization in the area is still uninterested in sponsoring the race as a group, it is potentially wise to talk personally to any individual who showed interest. Later effort by members, contacting businessmen or their own, may bring about necessary support to hold a good race in the district with no specific sponsor.

Among a Choice of Potential Sponsors: the following seem to be the most likely prospects in order of presentation:

1. Chamber of Commerce, if not sponsoring a competing event.
2. Local "character" clubs. (Doug Bard) "They eagerly accepted the idea, it seemed novel, suited to the area, and likely to attract interest and people to the area." In this case, the Bill Williams Mountain Men.
3. Young progressive service groups, The Jaycees, Winter Carnival Committees.
4. Motel Owners Associations.
5. Others. A large and ambitious racing club can rest grounds and handle the whole thing themselves.

The following seem to produce the least results, on the whole: (No special order)

Dog food companies. Promotional budgets are limited to some advertising, publicity at dog shows, etc. They will turn down dog sled races because a greater number can be reached through other events.

Single Large Corporations. An organization already making money with limited personnel, seldom shows much interest in an event guaranteeing little return and much need for workers and equipment, especially for an event which can be enjoyed by persons other than those spending money on the premises. A large hotel in a crowded resort area is usually a poor bet. A large hotel in an isolated location can be looked into as a potential sponsor.

(Mick Booth) "I feel you should get out and find a sponsor that has a reputation of doing things first class and right. Present your race to them along with all the publicity clippings from other races, if they go for it you're in business. If not, forget the whole deal. Don't settle for half-assed sponsors because it won't work out. It took two years to get our sponsor."

How Do You Contact Sponsors?

There are several ways that contact can be made with sponsors. These ideas have worked with varying degrees of success and only through trial and error can you determine which will work best for your club;

1. Write letters. Write to Chambers of Commerce or ask the Chamber of Commerce to provide you with a list of local service clubs and addresses of the officers. (Tim Trowbridge) "I wrote a letter to several such clubs throughout the state and asked other club members to do the same. We got almost no response although the Wisconsin Dells and Playboy races were the result of these letters. It seems much better if someone in the club knows someone personally in one of these organizations and can put in some person work. Our first letter goes out with a testimonial from past race sponsors, a copy of the Wall Street Journal article (ed: not included by any appropriate publicity release on sled dog racing could be used in this way), the ISDRA brochure (which sells at a small price and can be had by contacting the ISDRA secretary), and a brief bit about Trailblazers."

It is obvious that pre-organization of the racing club, with planning along the above lines, will pay off better than random talking by uninformed members. The North Star Sled Dog Club has produced a printed brochure which they send to Chambers of Commerce all over Minnesota.

2. Personal contact has great advantages in that potential sponsors cannot throw what is said into the waste basket! Anyone who is asked to contact sponsors should have seen or taken part in at least one sled dog race, and should have at least a slight understanding of how races are run. A club member who has a special "in" with a dominant organization in his area, should either be familiar with the operation of races, or should be accompanied by a knowledgeable club member when he is delegated to contact the organization. These delegates should report the results of their investigations at the regular club meeting or at least to the Race co-ordinator, in order that in the event two clubs are interested, the possibility of a race conflict with hurt feelings by one organization or the other will be eliminated. No member of the club should sign agreements with a sponsor until the club or Race Co-ordinator has received a complete report of his findings.

3. "Fun Races". Fun Races have in some areas proven useful as a spur to local organizations. (See Preliminary Races). Their only value seems to be in, sometimes fortuitously, attracting the attention of passers-by who may be intrigued by the idea and prove open to further discussion of a sponsored race. Because of the constant need for good publicity, all persons in the club who are running teams should strive to create a good impression whenever they and their dogs are seen working in public.

4. Other ideas. (Trowbridge) "Another gimmick we tried was a county fair circuit. We took several teams to a couple of county fairs in the summer and raced them once around the track. The spectators seemed to enjoy it greatly and we did get paid something, but it did not result in any winter races, which was our major goal."

One of the most important things to keep in mind is the ease of maintaining contact between your club and the sponsor. Letters and long distance phone calls do not substitute for personal and continuing contact up to race time. It is in the interest of the club and sponsor to maintain this contact. Thus, the best races are likely to be where ambitious and active mushers live. Your club members should be aware of their own self-interest, i.e., if they want to publicize and promote their own kennel, there is no better way than to have a race in their home town. They know the active local groups. Can maintain close personal contact, and the local people already know something about sled dog racing from having seen him train!

From Contact To Contract.

Almost all potential sponsors have regular meetings at which they are looking for some kind of entertainment. The major purpose of making the contact is to get an invitation to attend one of these meetings and present your package. A good movie on sled dog racing is just what the group is looking for in the way of entertainment. Still pictures and slides do not do the sport justice, so try to get a movie.

Actual presentation of the idea to the potential sponsor: As advised by several people:

- (1) Take a good film of a sled dog race to a regular meeting of the organization, on a pre-determined date if possible.

- (2) Stress activities that will make money for the sponsor. (See "Raising Money")
- (3) Only one person, who understands racing, should answer all questions and make the entire presentation.
- (4) Try to compromise on unimportant issues. They can be solved later. (Example: A request to have a team carry publicity signs at other events, etc. This may take some heavy thought by the club, but there's usually some way to fulfill such obligations.)
- (5) Do not ask for too much money for a first event. Stress the difference between a first time sled dog race and an established major event, if there is any question about whether or not the race will attract a huge entry, great numbers of spectators, etc. An over-ambitious plan for the first race may lead to complete collapse of racing in that area, caused by disappointment among both the sponsors and the participants.
- (6) Make up a publicity kit that contains information about sled dog racing and especially, good pictures that can be used by the sponsor in his publicity. Your club Historian should have press clippings from past events, photos, and other information that will be suitable for this purpose. If you can prepare press releases containing the expected entries, kinds of dogs that will be competing, drivers' racing records, etc., so much the better. You have this information so make sure it gets out.
- (7) Suggest associated activities that will draw the entire organization into the project and provide entertainment for members not interested in sled dog racing.
- (8) State what your racing club, if any, will do. Do not give the impression that the sponsoring organization must do it all. Make sure they understand that you and/or your club will supervise trail making, will take charge of entries, accommodations, trophies, timing, PA system, judging, or whatever the club has agreed in advance and CAN do.

Make sure you club really wants to put on a race with sponsorship, money and responsibility - or that you are prepared to handle all these matters on your own, if you have no club behind you.

The ideal approach is to present the potential sponsor with a finished package. He produces the money. You produce entertainment.

SAMPLE CONTACT BETWEEN RACE CLUB AND SPONSORS

This contract may seem unduly complicated and "scary" to both the novice racing club and the first-time sponsor of a sled dog race, but a contract of some kind is a necessity when any substantial amount of money and labor is at stake. It protects both the racing club and the sponsoring organization. This agreement is currently being used by the Great Lakes Sled Dog Association. It is intended as a guide only, for other clubs whose class events may differ, and whose divisions of responsibilities may not agree with those outlined here. Of greatest importance, when a racing club is dealing with a sponsor which promises to raise all the money, etc., is the establishment of responsibilities. Do not leave anything to chance. Do not rely on verbal agreements.

AGREEMENT

This agreement made and entered into the _____ day of 20_____, by and between (name of sponsor's representative) of (name of sponsoring organization), hereinafter referred to as "Sponsor", and (name of race-giving club), hereinafter referred to as "Club".

WITNESSETH

The purpose of this contract is to make an agreement for and enter in to an agreement concerning a sled dog race to be sponsored by the Sponsor and administered by the Club as in this agreement provided. It is hereby agreed by and between the parties hereto as follows:

1. The Club shall provide, operate and run a sled dog race to be held as follows:
Date _____
Starting time _____
2. The race shall be run and operated pursuant to the racing rules of the Club as they exist on the day of the race.
3. The Sponsor shall provide prize money for the race in the sum of _____ dollars (\$_____) of which _____ dollars (\$_____) being ten per cent of the prize money, has been paid contemporaneously with the execution of this agreement, receipt of which is hereby acknowledged. The deposit paid at the time of the execution of this agreement shall not be refundable to the Sponsor unless the race is cancelled by the Club.

If trophies have been purchased at the time a race is cancelled by a Sponsor, the Sponsor shall retain the trophies. If the Club shall cancel a race and the Sponsor has purchased the trophies, the Club will reimburse the Sponsor for the trophies purchased.

4. The Sponsor shall pay twenty per cent (20%) of the total purse, _____ dollars (\$____) at least one month before the race which amount shall not be refundable to the Sponsor unless the race is cancelled by the Club. The balance of the purse shall be paid to the Club on the day of the race at the mushers' meeting which will be held prior to the race. All payments shall be sent to the Treasurer of the Club, or other official of the Club designated by the Treasurer.
5. All prizes, payable from the purse, shall be distributed by the Club pursuant to determination made by the Club. Ninety per cent, (90%) of the prize money paid by the Sponsor shall be used for prizes. The balance of 10% (ten per cent) shall be used by the Club for expenses of the race and other proper Club purposes.
6. The Club and Sponsor shall each appoint a race chairman who shall be in charge of the activities of the Club and Sponsor respectively. The Sponsor shall perform the following acts pursuant to the instructions of the Club's chairman:
 - a. Prepare all trails for Open Class, Class A, Junior Race and Children's Race.
 - b. Provide trophies for the foregoing races as follows: Open Class, first through fourth places. Class A, First through fourth places. Junior Race, first through third places. Children's Race, First through third places.

The trophies shall be ordered by the Sponsor at the direction of the Club's race chairman, but the sponsor shall not be obligated to spend in excess of _____dollars (\$) for all the aforesaid trophies, but shall spend a minimum of _____ dollars (\$).

7. Provide (1) adequate parking space for the mushers' motor vehicles, and (2) a stakeout area for the dogs of sufficient size which shall be near the starting line and parking space (together). Both the parking space and the stake-out area shall be approved by the Club's race chairman.
8. Provide sufficient adult residents from the local area to be helpers on the trails during the races. The Club's race chairman shall advise the Sponsor's race chairman of the number of such persons required at least ten days prior to the race.
9. Provide adequate publicity in local and state-wide news media.
10. The Club shall perform as follows:
 - a. Provide at least two divisions of sled dog races including Open Division and Class A Division.
 - b. Provide the following equipment:
 - i. Public address system and announcer.
 - ii. Snow fence for starting chutes.
 - iii. Sufficient timers and adequate timing equipment.
 - iv. Race officials pursuant to the rules of the Ass'n.
 - v. Trail markers pursuant to the rules of the Ass'n.
 - vi. Race numbers for racers pursuant to the rules of the Ass'n.
 - vii. A minimum of one announcement in a national sled dog magazine which shall be at least _____ inches by _____ inches in size.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the parties hereunto have executed this agreement.

Sponsor

By_____

Title

Race- Giving Club

By_____

Title

A Typical APPROACH TO SPONSOR

This outline, suitable to use in a presentation to a potential sponsor, was made up by members of the Trailblazers Sled Dog Club of Wisconsin. It is suggested that a new race club make a similar outline. However, careful study of the "E section" will suggest that the race club restrain its optimism when making up its plan/ outline for presentation to the sponsors - or for clarifying its own responsibilities and obligations.

I. Sled Dog Racing

- a. Origin- old sport in North America (Eskimos/Indians)
 - i. Relatively new in the midwest, growing fast
 - ii. Formal racing began in Alaska in 1908 - 408 miles
- b. Dogs and Equipment
 - i. Breeds of dogs used: Most common are arctic breeds (Siberian, Malamute) many highbred used.
 - ii. Sleds - 8', about 40 pounds, ash, hickory, oak
 - iii. Ganglines - polyethylene. Harness - nylon webbing, custom fit.
- c. Race Classes
 - CLASS A - 5 dogs or more over 10-20 mile trail
 - CLASS B - 3-6 dogs over 5-10 mile trail
 - CLASS C - 2-3 dogs over 3-5 mile trail

II. Sources of Revenue

- a. Entry Fees (these have not been definitely set, but for the sake of this presentation let's assume you want a race on the caliber of Ely/ St. Paul - International.
- | |
|--|
| CLASS A - 15 entries @ \$25 = \$375 |
| CLASS B - 20 entries @ \$15 = \$300 |
| CLASS C - <u>20</u> entries @ \$5 = <u>\$100</u> |
| 55 |
| \$775 |
- b. Race Programs Show Three Lakes ads.
1. Sell advertising in race program.

1 Page @ \$50 times 10 pages = \$500
$\frac{1}{2}$ page @ \$30 times 10 pages = \$500
$\frac{1}{4}$ page @ \$20 times 5 pages = \$400
1/8 page @ \$15 times <u>5 pages = \$600</u>
30 pages = \$2000
 2. Cost of program

.25 basic cost
<u>.30</u> ad cost (.01 per page) (can be $\frac{1}{2}$ cent if they do all typing and lay-out for ads)
.55 (or .40) total cost per programs (or \$400)
 3. Sell programs to spectators

Sell 1000 @ \$1 each = \$1000
Subtract costs
<u>550</u>
\$ 450 profit
 4. Other sources of Revenue:

Parking
Concessions
Buttons and Patches (sales)
Raffle
Race Sponsorships (sell sideboards or banners to be carried on the sides of sleds @ \$100)

III. Division of Responsibilities

a. Sponsor Responsibility - Provides:

Trails	Trophies	Liability Ins. For spectators	Local Publicity
Purse	Helpers on trail	Starting chute/holding area	

b. Trailblazers' Responsibility - Provides:

Liability insurance	PA System	Timing system
Race numerals	Announcer	Timers
Teams in all classes	Race officials	Aid in Publicity for Sponsor

THE HARD FACTS ABOUT A SLED DOG RACE

Some figures such as actual totals of entry fees received, and costs of insurance for the racing club and participants, are not included in this tabulation. However, those items listed should serve as a guide to the pitfalls and triumphs of putting on a sled dog race. Prize money offered was \$1000 with some of the prize money coming out of the entry fees.

ANTICIPATED EXPENSES		ACTUAL EXPENSES		INCOME OR PROFIT	
Musher's banquet	\$120	Musher's Banquet	\$120	Musher's Banquet	\$112
Race Programs	\$...	Race Programs	600	Race Programs	
Trophies	\$100	Trophies	(donated)	and decals	\$204
Purse	\$900	Purse	\$900	Chamber of Commerce	\$100
Plowing Parking area	\$ 50	Plowing Parking	\$244.26	Entry fees	\$278
(cost \$35 in 1970)		(Town 35.36 Streets 208.50)			
Advertising	\$150	Advertising	\$185.35		
		(newspapers 33.00 posters			
		20.00, WCUB 33.75, WOMT			
		48.60, WQTC 50.00)			
Trail Preparation	\$ 50	Trail Preparation	\$175	Donation	\$100
		Envelopes, postage	\$ 13	Ads, program	\$1262.50
		Mimeo paper	3		
TOTAL	\$1470.00	TOTAL	\$2240.61	TOTAL	\$2057.10
Anticipated profit: \$587.10		Actual loss:	\$183.51		

Other Clubs' Experience

Similar tabulations from other races tell a remarkably uniform story about the pitfalls of putting on a race event.

Race I. Estimated cost to clear parking area, \$50.00. Actual cost \$275.00. Donation by Race Marshall, \$100.00. Deficit for entire race, \$24.00.

Race II. Estimated cost to clear parking area, \$200.00. Actual cost, Zero. Clearing donated by county equipment. Profit, entire race, \$26.00.

Race III. Clearing parking area, donated. Advertising for program promised, \$480. Payment collected, \$395. Deficit after all expenses, \$17.

Race IV. Paid over \$400.00 to have parking area cleared only to find that the city would have done this at no charge but was never contacted.

Guidelines:

Allow for inclement weather and extra expense. NEVER ASSUME ANYTHING! Leave no stone unturned in your search for assistance in putting on your race.

GRADUATED RACE PLANNING

Refer to necessary chapters in this Race Manual for details in each heading. Embellishments on any plan may be added whenever there is sufficient personnel and/or money. This outline should serve as an outline for necessities only.

THE LOCAL RACE

Anticipated Entry from Within a Local Area

Personnel: Five or more persons working on day of race.

Trail Equipment: Whatever packing equipment is available. One snowmobile, minimum (plus drag if available).

Publicity: Press releases to local newspapers and radio stations. Posters throughout the local area.

Prizes and Awards: Minimum, trophies or merchandise prizes to all class winners. Prize money (if any): On "pot race" basis divided- 40%, 30%, 20%, and 10% suggested to top four teams after paying race expenses from entry fees.

Financing: Obtain donations where possible. Should be acknowledged in publicity releases and in program.

Program, Entry List etc.: Duplicate or mimeograph. School or church may cooperate.

Expected Entries: Up to 30 (Plus or minus) teams maximum in all classes, combined.

Classes: Unlimited and Limited Classes. (Limited classes are limited to the maximum number of dogs allowed on the team.)

If only small, limited class teams are expected and personnel is limited, a single combined class of limited teams may be run on a short course.

Trails: A simple loop or in-out trail, with closed-in turn-around for smaller team classes (requiring little supervision of checkers) is advised. Unlimited length: up to 15 miles or maximum distance which can be properly maintained and manned with limited personnel. Limited length: one mile for each dog allowed in the class (example: 3 dog class = 3 miles). Above guideline may be reduced or lengthened, depending upon conditions and the quality of the teams and drivers.

Race site Equipment: Timer's watch, timer's table or car. Rope and stakes to mark starting chute. Spray paint to mark start/finish on snow. Signs where needed to limit parking.

Marking Equipment: Spray painted paper pie plates and stakes to mark course. Signs, if more suitable, at turn-arounds, etc...

Other Desirable Equipment: Portable toilets (at least one) if no public facilities within the race area. Bullhorn or loud-speaker. Refreshment table (coffee, tea, and cocoa, minimum). Warming fires (if permitted and no other warming facilities are available).

Notes:

With a limited area and limited personnel, it is unwise to schedule more than the basic classes of racing at a first event on a small budget. Do a better job on a smaller race. Local business people will usually donate trophies or merchandise readily if asked by friends and if not too much is demanded.

Publicity is vital, even though the race may not be heavily attended, to bring local people out and arouse interest or an improved or expanded event in later seasons.

The trail should be as good as possible. The less experienced the drivers and the teams, the more important a well packed, simply planned trail must be. The "local race" is best scheduled for only one day, preferably a Sunday when the largest attendance may be expected.

If support from experienced drivers is expected, provide a good enough course to make running worth their while. When little or no money is at stake, the quality of the trail itself becomes all important to the experienced driver who may be running his team dogs to add to their experience before entering them in larger events. Nobody will return to a badly organized, dangerous, mismanaged or inaccurately timed race.

THE REGIONAL RACE

Anticipated Entry from Within the State and Nearby States/ Provinces

Personnel: Eight and preferably more persons working on actual race days.

Trail Equipment: will require mechanical packing equipment and preferably, assistance from snowmobile club and/ or local business firms, community road/service departments.

Publicity: Radio, television and newspaper advertisements. If not feasible and within the budget, make an effort to get as much publicity as possible in all areas through quality publicity releases. Should cover all regional outlets and those in major urban areas within a day's driving distance from the race site. Advertising in sled dog publications and bulletins to attract entries.

Prizes and Awards: Trophies, preferably donated, to third place in each class. Prize money: minimum \$500. Maximum purse to be determined by potential sponsors, program advertising sales, business community contributions, fund raising endeavors, etc...

Financing: Raised by above means and other suggested in "Raising Money," page G-1.

Program and Entry List: Printed programs with advertising and information of interest to spectators. Combined advertising and spectator sales revenues should at least recoup costs of program, if not show a profit.

Expected Entries: May number 10 or more Unlimited Class teams and 15 or more in each limited class event, but can be much more, depending on the location of the race.

Classes: Unlimited Class and Limited Classes (limit to number of dogs allowed on team). Additional events may include Junior Races, PeeWee race, weight pull and lead dog contests, etc., dependent upon availability of contestants and regional interests. Some of the additional events may not require additional personnel but some may as it applies to non-race dog contests.

Trail: A more ambitious trail may be planned if more people are available to act as checkers, as well as persons to maintain the trail. Circular or loop courses are most desirable for all classes to avoid head-on passing. Distances of trail are the same as those suggested under the "local race" heading.

Race Site Equipment: All as mentioned under "local race", *plus* sound system (loudspeaker). Refreshment booth or truck to serve spectators. Men's and Ladies' toilets if no public facilities at race site. Cooperation of road department necessary to provide spectator parking, etc.

Marking Equipment: Need better trail marking as more intricate courses and faster teams develop. Use painted plywood markers, 10 inches across.

Other Desirable Equipment: Dog-marking equipment. Separate booth to sell programs, souvenirs, etc. Snow fencing to mark off chute, rope and stakes to exclude spectators from holding area, barricades to close musher parking lot.

Directional signs to race site to be posted on major roads.

Notes: A "regional" race is best scheduled for two days with most "extra" events run on Sunday.

THE CLASSIC RACE

Anticipated Entry from throughout the North American Continent and Europe

Personnel: As many reliable people, assigned to separate pre-race and race-day jobs as are needed to conduct race.

Trail Equipment: Both heavy and light equipment as required for quality maintenance.

Publicity: May include radio, television, newspapers for wide radius, travel magazines, regional promotion brochures, posters, etc. Large scale advertising in sled dog publications.

Prizes and Awards: All as stated under "regional race," plus whatever "specials" are desired (best Canadian team, best American team, best conditioned team etc.). Minimum purse of \$3,000 is Unlimited Class with commensurate purses for limited class events to be determined by the sponsoring group.

Expected Entry: Between 15 to 20 in Unlimited Class (more or less dependent upon race location, time of race and size of purse), 20 on up in all limited class races, could be much more. It may be desirable to run only two classes in such a race (an unlimited and one limited class race) to accommodate race site and time limitations.

Classes: Emphasis in "classic" races is usually upon the unlimited class race. By the same token and because of physical limitations, some "classic" limited class races, are run, usually featuring two or more limited class events (maximum number of dogs allowed on team determines the name of the class).

Trail: Unlimited, 16 to 20 miles (plus or minus), to be perfectly maintained and designed for the fastest possible performances (no hazards). Limited Class: Preferable a few more miles than the number of dogs allowed in each limited class. (Example: 3-dog teams, 4 plus miles). In sanctioned races, all mileages and team maximums are subject to ISDRA sanctioning rules and requirements. Preferably, trails for different classes should be entirely separated from one another but if this is not possible, should be monitored by trail officials to negate confusion. No two or more classes should be traversing the trail at the same time.

Race Site Equipment: Everything required in a "regional" race and if possible, a separate van or tower for the race timers and race announcer. Complete equipment to block off holding area from spectator vehicle access. Feeder fencing from holding area to starting chute. Trash cans. Radio car. Everything imaginable to assist in crowd control and official duties. Media station manned by a representative of the community and the race sponsoring organization.

Marking Equipment: As in a "regional" race, plus snow fence for barricades on course, if necessary etc. Mile markers, if possible. Trail signs should be checked prior to the run of each day's events.

Drug Testing Equipment: If testing is to be done, equipment is available through the testing laboratory.

Dog Marking Equipment: Refer to "Marking Dogs" in this Race Manual, Page O-1.

Other Personnel: Police and Highway Control personnel. Veterinarian.

SENSIBLE RACE PLANNING

The beginning club or individual wishing to put on a dog race will not find entries available even if local support can be obtained to the tune of several thousand dollars. Any attempt to put on a large-scale race without adequate experienced help will only meet failure and confusion. Dog drivers do not trust a brand-new event unless it is being planned and organized by an experienced group in an area where sled dog racing is traditional and well understood. For this reason, any new club is well advised to start with an excellently managed, nicely laid-out "local" race which will not impose a great financial burden on the club and can be produced and managed by a few knowledgeable persons.

A good, small race will encourage the sponsoring race organization, build interest among potentially generous civic groups and will influence team owners to attend a future event through good reports and by word-of-mouth. Putting on a good "local" race will ready the local club for more advanced planning. They will find that a "local" race keeps every one busy enough in its initial year.

An over-ambitious race which attracts fewer teams than expected and at which the helpers are spread too thin, almost guarantees its own demise due to the disappointment of both the participants and the organizations which have lent their support. This is especially critical in an area where sled dog racing is accepted and appreciated, from which many good teams may emerge to take part in a new organization's first race. With a wide choice of events to choose among in following seasons, they will avoid the scene of an earlier, bad experience.

Publicity is the most important feature of any race to the outside sponsor (s). The *trail* is the most important feature of any race to the participant with *accurate timing* running a very close second. *Money* becomes the determining factor between a well-attended race and a skimpily-entered one when there are other races of equal caliber in the vicinity.

EXPENSES

A "local" race can usually pay its own bills through the use of fair entry fees. Depending upon how much time and equipment is donated by outside concerns, the racing club or individuals may have to spend \$100 (or less) to \$300. In lieu of donating a trophy or cash, hardware stores may donate rope, stakes, paint, etc., if given proper recognition. The preceding is just an example of what can be done if the few workers are active and follow all leads in getting help and interest for the race.

A "regional" race, if properly managed, may cost twice as the "local" race.

Some of the major "classic" races in North America, with purses ranging between \$10,000 and \$25,000 (plus or minus), allocate anywhere from \$2,000 to \$6,000 (plus or minus) to cover promotion and production expenses. It should be apparent that planning and executing a "classic" race is a year-round business requiring the cooperation and hard work of a large, dedicated sled dog club backed by enthusiastic community support or that of a major financial sponsor.

Some money-raising methods can be fun and profitable for everyone involved. See the chapter on financing in this Race Manual starting on page G-1.

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RAISING MONEY

Several dozen money-raising methods are here presented for the consideration of clubs and sponsoring organizations. Choose methods that seem practical for your own area. You will find at least a few ideas no matter how isolated or "poor" your community may be. Final success or failure will result entirely from the amount of enthusiasm your club or assistants invest in the money-raising job.

Note: The legality of any "games of chance" or gambling activities must be checked out with the proper local, county or state authorities.

SINGLE SPONSORS. Not too frequently, a company will pay the expenses as does a large New York trucking firm, or has been done by Canadian beer and cigarette producers as a part of their advertising campaigns. Try the large or isolated winter resort or hotel if mere coverage of expenses is desired. Try local dog food manufacturers, (Nationally advertised products are not a good bet; consider how many other dog fanciers' groups and publications are asking big companies for support).

MULTIPLE SPONSORSHIP. A most common means of raising funds is the selling of advertising space on the racing sleds, in the form of banners. Prospective sponsors may be given the opportunity to choose the team they wish to sponsor, or the banner itself (with no guarantee which sleds will carry it) may be sold. A set fee from \$50.00 to \$100.00 is customary for this honor. Not practical in areas where individual teams are sponsored on a seasonal basis by a home-town concern. If there is to be radio or TV coverage of the race, this additional publicity should help in selling sponsorships.

PUBLIC SPONSORSHIP encompasses almost all other means of raising money. First, and most uniformly successful, is the use of public support through the Race Program or magazine/booklet.

THE PROGRAM. The race program can be as simple as a folded sheet of 9 x 12" card stock, containing a center spread devoted to the names of the drivers listed in starting order, with space to record their placing and times in each heat. The back cover consists of several small ads or one large expensive ad. The front cover generally as a racing scene of the type that would attract buyers. Such small program/leaflets usually sell to the public for .25. Cost of ads should be determined by the printing costs and the number of potential buyers (spectators). Ads should be priced to ensure that the program is entirely paid for by advertising.

PRINTING METHODS. Mimeographing or spirit duplication can be used for very cheap leaflets, entry lists, small programs. Most schools, churches and organizations own some kind of duplicating machine. Cost of 500 sheets printed (minus labor) from \$3 to \$5. Line drawings and typed copy only.

Offset printing (like this manual) permits use of photographs as well as drawings and camera-ready typed copy. Cost for 500 sheets, printed both sides, 8 1/2 x 11", when material is presented AS IT IS INTENDED TO LOOK ON THE FINAL PRINTED PAGE is from \$20 to \$30. When the printer must arrange the copy and reduce photos or drawings, or set bold titles, cost is from \$5 to \$10 more.

Other printing processes are more expensive, depending upon services required and quantities ordered.

Use of a second color in printing covers, even by offset process, is often worth the additional charge (\$2 or more) in greater sales potential.

MAGAZINES OR BOOKLETS. The more ambitious club with more potential advertisers and spectators may wish to publish an annual souvenir magazine which sells for \$1.00 or more. Offset or "slick" printing is recommended. Suitable table of contents:

- Historical and contemporary race stories.
- Facts of interest about sled dogs.
- Pictures. (Types of dogs, teams, participants.)
- Score sheet.
- Condensed racing rules.
- Map of course.
- Capsule biographies of each racing driver.

Articles and information suitable for inclusion in such a booklet are easily obtainable from other established sled dog clubs as well as from ISDRA. A complete list of currently active racing clubs is available from the ISDRA Secretary.

SECRETS OF SUCCESS IN PROGRAM SALES

You should have a selling group organized well before your event. Sales can be made from news stands, through motels, hotels, restaurants, etc., or by vendors within the organization or club, BEFORE and THROUGHOUT the weekend of the race. Sales can be made through outside organizations such as service and youth groups, payment being a percentage of the sales price. Do not depend on the junior members of the racing club to do the work at the races, unless they have previously proven themselves hard workers. The program committee should circulate constantly at the races, with ample quantities of programs in hand as well as any other items being sold to raise money. Have programs available at the refreshment stand and information booth or desk.

Sell your programs as early and fast as possible even if you sell out before the end of the race. Advertisers pay for space expecting their ads to be seen, not left over in the printer's carton.

SELLING ADS

A small club may choose to have its Program Committee handle all jobs from ad sales, right through layout, printing and finally, selling. Make up advertising contracts in advance, stating rates. These may be duplicated or mimeographed to keep costs down. Show sizes of the ads you are selling and attach an extra sheet marked off for half-page and full-page space. Carry a sample of your printer's work to show the advertiser. The printer will be glad to provide pamphlets and booklets he has done before, at no charge. You may wish to show advertisers a program printed by another racing club if you have an attractive example similar to what you plan to produce.

Advertising salesmen should contact businesses IN PERSON. Mailing requests for advertising produces little result.

Collect the price at the time of obtaining the ad, if possible. (It saves on billing expenses.)

Print in ink the information the advertiser wants in the booklet, on the size space he had contracted to buy.

HINTS FOR THE PROGRAM CHAIRMAN

1. Set deadlines to bring in all material well before the printer's deadline.
2. Keep ad sales force small and mobile. Choose popular and reliable people.
3. Make ad prices high enough to completely pay for printing booklet; low enough to encourage buying by the smallest businesses.
4. Don't forget the credits on borrowed articles and pictures.
5. If nobody in the club is capable of doing meat typing and ad layouts, pay the extra charge to have the printer do these things.

GIMMICKS

Some books and programs include a "gimmick" to encourage sales. Where it involves a "gambling flavor", the legality of such methods should be ascertained before going ahead with the project. They include such contests as "Pick the Winner and His Time", or "Pick the Top Ten", always with space to write in the winning time estimate in the event of a tie. Containers are placed within the race area where the contest entries, torn from the booklet, may be deposited to be picked up before the end of the race. Prizes are usually sums of money; if this is not legal, the winner may receive a husky pup, a pair of skis, a bottle of liquor, etc.

BUTTON, PENNANTS, ETC. Sled Dog Racing "Buttons" (or badges) are commonly sold to support most racing events. The more you order, THE LESS EACH UNIT COSTS, AND THE MORE PROFIT IS AVAILABLE. An average cost, per plastic pin-back button, is \$.23. Average selling price is \$.50 apiece. There are companies throughout the nation which manufacture buttons and other specialties. Some are equipped to make a standardized sled dog race button with a husky head design. All will adapt your club design, or any other simple pattern, for a small extra charge. To find the nearest dealer, check big-city telephone directory for manufacturer's under the headings "Advertising Specialties" or "Badges". Allow at least two months, especially when dealing with a distant factory. A small club should not have the date of its event printed on its souvenirs; thus they may be sold the next year, or at any time of the year, if they are not sold immediately.

All club members and "boosters" should wear buttons all over their clothes on race day (s). They sell readily to an eager public. Do not sell your buttons at a rival club's races.

Pennants, canes and other souvenirs should be sold from a special booth at the race. They are too subject to damage when carried out in crowds and bad weather.

PATCHES AND DECALS. Practical for large sled dog clubs with many boosters. Both are initially expensive in most cases. Information is usually available from companies advertising "Bowling Apparel" or under heading "Decalomanias" in city phone books.

RAFFLES. Good money-raising methods, because they can take place at any time of year and need not offer prizes connected with the sled dog races or dependant upon race attendance. Attempt to obtain prizes as donations from local businesses. Favorite prizes: TV sets, cases of liquor, sporting equipment (the latter especially popular in resort areas). Organization or group sponsoring the raffle may print tickets on locally owned duplicator; this leaves the cost of the prize as only expense. Many sled dog clubs raffle at least one puppy per year, offering cash value of the pup as alternative award. Proper wording on tickets can make money prizes legal. Usual ticket price, .50 or three-for-a-dollar. All members of racing club or sponsoring organizations sell tickets.

CARNIVALS - FAIRS. All supplies (games, prizes etc) may be rented and/or bought from city companies advertising "Carnival Supplies". Your local high school may know the best near-by dealer. Plan booths at local fairs, when permitted, or hold your own carnival. One sled dog club clears from \$250 to \$300 every Fourth of July, after expenses (booth rental, Wheel of Fortune rental, payment for broken cases of prizes) are paid. The entire operation is handled by only two local members of the club.

Sales of souvenirs along with a sled dog display at local fairs may be lucrative. Clubs have sold along with buttons, pennants, ceramic dog figures, pins etc., such items as home-made jams and jellies, candy, painted cushion covers, paper weights, pine cone decorations, etc. the creative members of the club supply the items. The non-creative members sell them.

BAKE SALES, YARD SALES, RUMMAGE SALES, WHITE ELEPHANT SALES, ETC. All such sales are profitable, especially during the summer season, and possible during a time when help is more available.

INTRA-CLUB SALE. This is a good project for the sled dog club itself. It may be held in conjunction with an old-fashioned box social (box lunches are auctioned off with all proceeds going to the club treasure). The intra-club sale involves items of winter clothing, dog equipment, etc., which are offered for sale with a percentage of the sale price being turned over to the club's race fund. It is most apt to be successful in an area with many dog owners and winter sports enthusiasts.

SWEEPSTAKES TICKETS. Check legality in your state. Tickets may be sold all year, several drawings held throughout racing season or only one drawing at the main event of the year. Offer a prize to the seller of the winning ticket to encourage sales.

WINNING TIME TICKETS Check into legality. Spectators at the race may make as many guesses as they wish, at \$1.00 per guess, giving their estimate of what the TOTAL WINNING TIME of the race will be. Guesses may safely be sold up to within a half hour of the end of the race. (Guesses should be in hours, minutes and seconds. It is easiest to prepare forms in advance with names, addresses and time-columns spaced down a sheet so that the seller can see at a glance if a choice has already been taken; this is easier than handling individual tickets. The sheets may be perforated with an unthreaded sewing machine to provide stubs to give the customer.) Give prizes or, if allowed, cash awards for the closest guess.

BINGO GAMES. Always a money-maker if competition from other organizations is not too great and a suitable meeting place is available.

BREAKFASTS AND BARBEQUES. A club in Southern California raised approximately \$200 by holding a breakfast-workout in a suburban park. Rental of cooking facilities is usually free or not more than \$10, by reservation only. Food is donated by club members; breakfast of ham, eggs, and pancakes sold for \$1.00 per person or more. Seeing dogs run will add to the appeal of the breakfast, for the public. Barbeques involve more labor and time but obviously bring in more money, when properly publicized, especially if held in conjunction with another event such as a fishing derby, jalopy races, fairs, etc. Many variations on the donated meal theme, such as clambakes, "buck stews" at the opening of the hunting season, and other affairs of this kind can be managed by even a small club.

DOG SHOWS. Fun matches (where a large population of show-dog owners exists) will bring from \$50 to \$200 or more. Any sort of dog show should be managed by a person with dog show experience and contacts among potential judges. A western club made over \$150.00 charging an entry fee of \$1.50 per dog, and selling soft drinks and hot dogs near the judging rings. Experienced breeders of arctic dogs judges the classes at no cost. Trophies were donated by club members; ribbons were bought from a trophy company. Again, advance publicity assures success. Where there are few show-minded people, a pet show with the usual classes (large pet, smallest pet, longest, prettiest, laziest, fastest, etc.) is fun to put on and easy to finance.

DOG SLED RIDES. Where there is good snow early in the season and an acceptable working area for small teams, (such as a market parking area that is not plowed etc.) it is possible to combine money-raising and publicity by giving dog sled rides. The matter of insurance should be carefully investigated; the cost may be too great to justify the effort. However, if a shopping center or large store is interested in have dog teams present for publicity, their insurance will usually cover the participants. The course should always be simple, level, well packed in advance, and as short as possible, (about $\frac{1}{4}$ mile at most). Beginning drivers with novice dogs SHOULD NOT undertake this activity for the sake of both drivers and the public.

CONCESSIONS AT RACES. The sponsoring organization may choose to build its own food booth or may let the concession to another organization (such as D.A.R., Campfire Girls, fraternal orders). If an outside group takes the concession, it may be required to turn over from 10% to 20% of the receipts. The menu should be simple, with both hot and cold drinks available. If you wish to sell beer, a permit must be obtained in most states. Buy as few perishables as possible (or seek donations of food items which cost the club nothing) as bad weather may reduce sales seriously.

TROPHY DONATIONS. While not tangible cash, donated trophies reduce the financial burden and therefore may be considered part of fund-raising. Many businessmen will donate trophies (or the cost of a trophy). One New Hampshire race awards ten top placing trophies, the more impressive going to the top three winners, with souvenir trophies to all the remaining contestants, all on funds derived from "trophy sponsors". To avoid inequalities in trophy awards, it is suggested that the club or group in charge of trophies establish the total cost in advance (i.e., average cost per trophy is \$3.50, plus engraving \$2.50) and set figures somewhat higher than that total to solicit from businessmen, Ask \$10.00 for a first place trophy, \$7.50 for second place, etc. The club should then buy all the trophies at one time and ensure that they are suitably engraved with the donor's name. The trophies may be returned to their donors to be on display until race time. There is no other way in which the club may be positive that donated trophies will be suitable - and will be there.

SELLING LAND OR LANDMARKS. In some areas money can be raised through mail-order "gimmick" sale of property either real or factitious. Such a scheme raised thousands of dollars for the first Iditarod Trail race in Alaska. An acre of Alaska land was sold by the square foot at \$2.00 per plot, with legal deeds issued to the buyers. Make sure it's legal, before you sell shares in the Brooklyn Bridge or a Texas oil well, but consider the possible income from sales of certificates that cost only a few cents each to print.

BOOKLETS, LEAFLETS, COOKBOOKS. Here are various items which have been sold by dog clubs to raise money. One talented member in the group is essential. A popular item will continue to bring in money as long as it is available.

Senator Vest's "Tribute to the Dog."

Favorite recipe collections.

Dog training books - especially sled dog training.

"A Dog Prayer to His Master".

Booklets on puppy care and feeding sold by club members to their customers.

THE "QUEEN" CONTEST. A properly run queen contest can be the key to a sponsor's financial and promotional success. In some cases, it has raised as much as \$10,000.00, most of the work done by a relatively few hard-working girls. It has worked successfully for big and small events alike and has become the financial backbone of some races. It requires a lot of promotion and support on the part of the race sponsor and begins with a request through local and/or state newspapers and other news media, for girls to run in the "Dog Derby Championship Queen Contest". The more enthusiastic cooperation a sponsor can get from the news media, the more enthusiastic the response. A "Queen Committee" takes charge of the girls and backs them with initial and weekly publicity (stories, pictures, and progress reports). They are given buttons, programs, patches, decals, etc., and in some cases, raffle tickets, to sell to the public, each sale dollar amounting to a certain number of points. In one case, each penny is a point, making the point gains should be impressive and in turn, making the contest appear even more progressive in the public eye. Small figures don't raise too much interest.

A very active group of girls will form teams around themselves and these teams, in turn, sell material to support their chosen candidate. Business firms and even entire small towns have been included in such promotions, backing girls with both financial and sales support.

A healthy, competitive spirit must be maintained within the group of contestants to attain peak performance. As in the case of most 'sales contest', two or three contestants take an early lead. It is imperative that the others not be discouraged by this turn of events. Putting the prize awards on a profit-sharing level helps to some extent. The prizes are dependent on the amount of dollars the group, as a whole, turns in and the money spent on prizes is based on a percentage of the total receipts. Generally speaking, the top three winners receive trophies and winter apparel, with the Queen's parka being made of fur in the largest contests. The remaining contestants, depending on total receipts, may receive boots, nylon parkas, trophies and/or flowers. In a very successful contest, a cash award is added. The profit sharing program serves to encourage all contestants as well as setting the right atmosphere to attract future candidates for future contests.

The Queen Contest usually closes the Saturday of a given race and is climaxed at the "Musher's Ball", where the queen is crowned and the other girls are recognized before the public. The Queen is assigned duties for the following day's race and is included in the awards ceremony.

A note of importance to those sponsoring Queen Contests which include the sales of programs and buttons (other racing souvenirs): the queens can be a main source of revenue during the actual contest, but once it is finished on Saturday, there must be an organized outlet for the remaining programs, buttons, and other items that are to be sold on the remaining day of the race.

Another method of promoting queen contests is for local businesses to put up their own candidates (employees, members of the owner's family, etc). The candidate takes little part in the contest personally; selling is done entirely by family and friends, and the only item of exchange is a ticket; votes are usually \$.50 apiece, or three for a dollar, and as above, the points are counted in pennies. With little urging, many businesses will gladly hang posters with portraits of their candidate attached. Psychologically, this process exerts more pressure on the public than if the queen candidates are trying to sell themselves. Few families or businesses will be willing to let their candidate go down to ignominious defeat if she begins to fall behind in receipts. From past experience, it has been found that the same individual may be forced to buy votes for two or three candidates just to keep peace with his clients and creditors.

SOCIAL EVENTS. The two most popular events are the Musher's Ball and the Musher's Supper. The sponsoring organization looks upon such events as an excuse to have a dance or a dinner to make money. Arrangements may vary from a member-donated pot-luck dinner up to a catered banquet; depending on the available facilities, admission may be limited to dog drivers and race officials only, or it may be open to an entire town. The labor of serving and cleaning, as well as rental of a building or hall, must be considered. This is a good fund raising source for small towns and working organizations, much like the old fashioned church suppers.

"BYOL" balls have proved successful, especially if the club or sponsor sells set-ups at a profit or hold a raffle in conjunction with the event, as well as charging admission. Include the cost of promotion and advertising in public news media when figuring expenses. Building rental and payment for a dance band are obvious drains; the potential attendance should be weighed carefully before deciding an event of this kind.

Large organizations with ample treasuries and a means of "emergency disposal" of over-buy can obtain a permit and sell club-purchased liquor with members tending bar. This almost ensures a good profit for the Musher's Balls. Assorted sandwiches and snacks add income to such a party. A good phonograph with lots of records often provides a cheap and satisfactory substitute for a band if there is plenty to drink and a pleasant atmosphere. A past expert at managing club dances for profit suggests that regardless of the number of persons a room will accommodate, about half the area should be taken up with tables and seating (and lots of ashtrays, please). It is to the sponsor's advantage to have people stay late and buy drinks well into the evening, when they will become hungry and buy food if it is available. Leftover liquor can usually be sold at a slight bargain at the end of the evening if the organization has no projected use for it (check state laws).

GATE RECEIPTS. A few races with ideal locations (start in stadium or densely wooded area which can be closed off) have been successful in charging admission to the general public. In return for the admission cost, buttons or tickets (to be held for a drawing) are given to the buyer to be used for purposes of re-entry, should he leave the premises. Unless such tickets (or almost any tickets) are clearly marked as "donation", special state permits may be in order and in some places, a tax must be collected. In Alaska, Sweepstakes tickets allow entry into certain Fairbanks events.

Holding and advertising special events, such as lead dog contests, weight pulling, scramble races, etc., within the confines of the stadium or closed off area will add incentive for paying to attend the race.

Do not rely on paid admissions to help finance events in any but an ideal location or under any but ideal circumstances (plenty of entrants in well-managed special event). Weather conditions can also affect such receipts. The necessity to pay to see the start of an ordinary sled dog race may turn away so many spectators that in the long run, the admission charge will be the ruination of the race.

PHOTOGRAPHERS. This scheme may be worked at races, or in the pre-Christmas season or even in the summertime if the club can prepare an effective backdrop and 'snow-like' flooring- indoors or outdoors. A reliable photographer with a good camera may be found among club members. Other members supply dogs and sled which is secured in position. Families are permitted to arrange themselves on the sled and near the dogs as they wish and are charges sufficient to ensure a good profit on three or four takes per family or group. Promote this plan for use on Christmas Cards. A busy shopping center is ideal. Props like animal skins, snowshoes, igloo, log cabin are desirable. Easily done if gentle dogs are used and no actual movement is expected from the team.

ENTRY FEES. (Variation of Pot Race) When an ambitious event is planned, in an area where there are plenty of prospective entrants, a good part of a large purse may be raised by demanding an excessively high entry fee (\$25 or more as compared to the usual \$10). This is not popular with the dog drivers. It should be done only where an excellent and high-paying race can be anticipated. Do not try to collect money through entry fees in an area with few competitive teams or where there are only one or two possible winners among those who or expected to attend. In any case, prize money should be paid to about 2/3rds of the entrants, when all are dunned for an excessively high entry fee.

PASSENGER RACES. In there are enough team-owners willing to participate, each small team may be "sold" to the highest bidder in the crowd for a short sprint race in full view. Teams are driven by the "buyer" with the regular driver riding in the basket. Ideally such events are run with a mass start. The winning team's prize money is divided between its "buyer" and its regular driver. A five-dog maximum is advised.

TRAINING SESSIONS: Club members provide lead dogs and equipment and hitch novice dogs at 50¢ \$1.00 per tryout. Good in heavy population areas.

SANTA CLAUS: Bring Santa to town, or to stores, for a fee. (Also good publicity.) Investigate insurance carefully.

PARADE FLOATS: Most parade sponsors offer cash awards for outstanding floats in many categories. Sled dog team floats are attention - getters and generally winners.

EDITOR'S NOTE: There has been no effort made to assemble fund-raising ideas in any logical or natural sequence, in as much as there is no logical in this aspect of sled dog racing. While one idea may work very well in a certain town, a closely related idea may not work at all. The sponsors, or financing committee, or ways-and-means committee should study all the fund-raising plans individually and collectively and settle upon the method (or methods) most likely to succeed in their own area. Intensive work to raise money by two or three systems will produce better results than desultory efforts in a half-dozen directions.

ANSWERING A PROSPECTIVE SPONSOR'S QUESTIONS ABOUT FINANCING

Most organizations in most areas will balk at sponsoring a sled dog race ONLY because they do not know how to raise money. They will turn away from any suggestion which intimates the need for digging into their treasury. Commonly, they will state that they have no treasury.

Often, an organization that willingly sponsored a first- year sled dog race will refuse to support a race for a second year, because the group was prepared improperly from the very beginning. Never suggest that the sponsor can take out money from his bank account to finance the race, and then expect the race itself to replenish the account. This does not happen. The "contact man " from the sled dog group must emphasize the need to raise money specifically for the race.

When a sponsor is determined to build up a race fund from scratch, he may then be pleasantly surprised by finding that his is over-subscribed, and that following the conclusion of the race there is a considerable amount of money left over for the next year's race or for another event.

The "contact man" is assumed to be a person who is familiar with the race area and its problems. It is suggested that he study the money-raising methods listed here before he speaks to the prospective sponsor, so that he can submit a list of

appropriate schemes that will be of interest to these particular group. He should cull out those ideas that would definitely no appeal to the persons in question. For instance, a dog show would not be appropriate in a small farming community which owned few purebred dogs, whereas a Sunday morning outdoor breakfast might be perfect. A lively Mushers' Ball with drinking and noisy dancing is often not feasible in a community where only the church basement is large enough - but a bake sale/ white elephant sale might be a success.

Fund-raising plans which involve great numbers of people (dog shows, cook-outs, button sales and the like) should not be attempted by individuals or very small groups working on a first event. It is possible for a single person to obtain ads, lay out and have printed a small race program which can be sold at one or two locations on the race site with no need for large numbers of salesmen. Raffle tickets can be sold by family and friends and do not need a big committee for preparation. Choose money-raising projects that are in keeping with the supply of workers and possible demand.

On the other hand, if the "contact man" is meeting with a big, active organization that includes many young families and active sportsmen, such projects as club carnivals, but potluck dinners, barbeques, etc., may be right up their alley.

Assess your prospective sponsors carefully. Emphasize the fact that they can put money in their pockets by holding a sled dog race - but only by doing active work toward it, not by sitting back and waiting for the "big attraction" to draw thousands of free- spending spectators. Race after race falls into this trap, promising crowds that never appear (especially if the weather is dubious). However, if the town is prepared in the methods outlined in this book, poor attendance will not prove such a disaster and even a modest profit from race-day receipts will leave a pleasant taste in the sponsor's mouths. Nearly all of those who work for the race will come to the race and, quite frankly, will give one another the impression that there is "quite a crowd here". If they have fun and are not mentally adding up the deficit in the treasury, the race will be launched into its second year. So THINK POSITIVE about money-raising from the start; say "This is how you can get..." not, "This is what you must give..."

SAMPLE FORM FOR TIME-GUESSING CONTESTS (Can be used in books or as flyers)

FUN - FUN JACKPOT

JUST GUESS WHAT TODAY'S WINNING TIME WILL BE. FILL IN SPACE PROVIDED BELOW AND TAKE TO TICKET BOOTH WHERE IT WILL BE RECORDED IN THE BOOK. ALL IT COSTS IS \$1.00 (ONE DOLLAR) AND IF YOUR GUESS IS CLOSEST TO THE WINNING TIME YOU WIN TODAY'S JACKPOT. TO ASSIST IN YOUR GUESS WE HAVE LISTED BELOW THE WINNING TIMES FOR THE PAST FIVE YEARS.

RACE	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
David Dial	55:05	42:02	35:38	36:18	35:07
12 Mile Race	No Race	45:27	41:25	41:33	40:46
14 Mile Race	No Race	47:40	49:36	50:49	46:50
16 Mile Race	No Race	55:03	49:57	54:57	1:00:00
16 Mile Race	No Race	No Race	47:44	51:49	59:06

ENTRY BLANK

NAME _____ PHONE _____

ADDRESS _____ CITY _____

MY GUESS IS: -----
 MINUTES SECONDS

PERMIT NO. 68-41

NUMBER RECORDED

PUBLICITY

ADVISORS:

Robert LeVorsen, California
Tim Trowbridge, Wisconsin
Cynthia Molburg, New Hampshire
Joe Redington, Sr., Alaska

PUBLICIZE YOUR RACES AND.....you will see the following results: Bigger crowds...Happier sponsors...More new members and teams.

A COMMON CRY: "WE NEVER NEW ABOUT IT!"

The amount of publicity and the "lure" should be adapted to the race is question. Make sure your event can live up to its billing. Concentrate heavy publicity on serious events that have a definite schedule and provisions for the crowd you anticipate.

The public at large should not be invited to sled dog events that are primarily designed to train drivers or train dogs. They want to see speed, efficiency and fast action.

"PUBLICITY" is the key to making a good race turn out to be a resounding success, and sets the stage for an even better race next year.

- I. THE PUBLICITY CHAIRMAN. Every club of any size should have a publicity chairman whose job is to publicize races both before the event and after it is over. He should accumulate all the material he can get from other clubs, from magazines, and other sources, He should be in charge of keeping on file all pertinent ISDRA communications, photographs, and other data (such as other clubs' programs and booklets) which might be of help to him in performing his job. This will help him answer questions that he might not be able to answer from personal experience in interviews and when he writes publicity releases. He should be well provided with pictures of teams and dogs; if he cannot obtain these from other drivers, he should be prepared to take photos of his own equipment and "perfect" photos are not necessary. Newspapers will accept photos which are repugnant to the perfectionist dog driver. Action and clarity are the most important features of a good publicity picture. Eight by ten inch glossy prints are most desirable.
- II. PUBLICITY WITH THE CLUB. To keep up interest, it is advisable to send out newsletters once a month if possible, to all members of the racing club. In addition, information about an upcoming race should be mailed well before the race. Results of the race should be mailed immediately after its completion. Try to encourage continued interest among inactive members, If they hear enough from the club, their interest may revive, This publicity communication should be handled by a Newsletter Editor in the larger clubs, rather than the Publicity Chairman.



III. PUBLICITY OUTSIDE THE CLUB

DISPLAY ADS. Prices vary depending on the newspaper. These are very useful in small town papers. Their value is questionable in large-city newspapers, unless your group has a very high budget for advertising. Buying one or two display ads may encourage the paper to give the races much superior coverage to what it would do otherwise.

CLASSIFIED ADS. Inexpensive, and when included in the "pet section", "sporting goods" section and "personals" section, may attract a lot of interest.

TELEVISION. Call local TV stations well ahead of time and arrange an interview with the sports or news editor. Explore all possibilities for "free advertising". Non-profit organizations can often get "spots" (during station-breaks, etc) at no cost. The TV station will usually request a good, clear photo layout that is camera-ready for spot announcements.

RADIO. Distribute information about the races to all radio stations, for their "current events" programs. Investigate costs of spot announcements. Do not automatically eliminate the possibility of getting radio coverage of the race itself. This is done annually at some races in Alaska and New England.

Unless a club member or members are personally acquainted with someone in the various media, the publicity chairman should telephone TV and radio stations, ready with his "spiel", repeatedly if necessary. His preparation for this effort should be obvious from the following sample conversations:

(Pub Dir.) "I would like to speak to Mr. Tom Brown please." (Tom Brown is the Sports Bureau Co-ordinator. Find out his name before you call.)

(Tom Brown) "Hello. What can I do for you?"

(Pub. Dir.) "This is Mr. (name) speaking. Our organization, the Northern Sled Dog Club, would like to introduce your viewers to our sport prior to the championship race scheduled for January 10th. We have husky racing dogs, drivers and equipment available for an interview. When would be the most convenient time to get together with you?"

Chances are good that Tom Brown will now say, "I didn't even know you had any sled dog races around here", and the conversation will progress from that point.

The Publicity Chairman should send out a publicity release, concerning a local driver and his team or a local driver's accomplishment in a race elsewhere, every week, if possible, prior to and during the race season. He should send more information than the newspaper, radio station or TV station might require with pertinent information at the "head" of the story. Unusual occurrences attract the most interest...so not underestimate the interest of the media in the unusual.

PRESS RELEASES. Written material should be double-spaced, neatly typed and properly spelled. Releases that need deciphering and much editing are set aside in favor of better presented material vying for space in the sports pages. Who, what, when, where and why should be explained concisely in the first paragraphs of the article. Small newspapers may accept articles as written but don't depend on it. Larger (city and daily) newspapers will undoubtedly re-write, and will want facts - NOT style.

ACCEPTABLE DETAIL

"Matched gray Siberian Huskies"

"10 degrees below zero"

"George Smith drove 8 Harris Hounds"

NON-ACCEPTABLE DETAIL

"Beautiful team of registered huskies"

"Bone-chilling temperatures"

"George Smith's spectacular team"

In other words...let the editor or newsman add his own embellishments. Give him facts, no matter how unimportant, but don't give him the sentiments or fancy adjectives. Do use terms such as "record-breaking" if there is any basis in fact for such description; include the previous record time and the name of the person who accomplished it and when.

Deliver, mail or phone (mail is acceptable to weeklies) race results to the Editors, IMMEDIATELY. The publicity chairman should have established which person, in which department, to ask for, WELL BEFORE THE RACE.

Invite Editors, Reporters and Newsmen to attend the races. If they accept, a club member (if not the publicity chairman) should be alerted to welcome them and act as coordinator and assistant to the newsmen during the time they are present at the race. YOUR CLUB SHOULD NEVER INVITE ANYONE TO THE RACE WITHOUT ASSIGNING A HOSPITALITY CHAIRMAN OR SOMEONE TO BE IN CHARGE OF MAKING THESE PEOPLE COMFORTABLE AND INFORMED WHEN THEY ARRIVE. Sled dog racing is a relatively "new" sport to most reporters and they will have a lot of questions to ask. Without the answers, a good story is impossible!

A SAMPLE OFF-SEASON OR PRE-RACE PRESS RELEASE. (Double space and include name and address of writer on each page in upper left-hand corner. Number pages at upper right-hand corner. If more than one page, mark "MORE" on the bottom and at the end of the release, mark finish with: ### or -30- or XXX or the word "end".

SAMPLE

Bob Blank, Secretary
Central Sled Dog Club
Central City, Centralia

Page 1 of two

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE (or release date)

CENTRAL CITY- CENTRALIA - Plans for the first annual City Center Championship Sled Dog Races (what and where) were announced today by the Central Sled Dog Club (who).

The sled dog races, including both professional and amateur from seven states (more what and who) will be held at Pelton's Meadow, near Center City (more definite where) on January 11 and 12, starting at 10A.M. each day. (Specific when.)

In addition to the \$500 first prize which will be awarded to the fastest dog team, many special prizes will lure the "mushers". Teams from as far away as Alabama and New Mexico are expected to attend, including the World's Champion of 1973, Jim Wowser.

Sled Dog racing has been adjudged one of the nation's fastest growing sports. The first race outside of Alaska was held in 1971 in Ashton, Idaho. Last year

MORE

Please remember that the above is doubled-spaced, typed clearly, with the proper spelling and specific information which would interest the spectators. Save the "boring" details about class sizes, distances and prize money distribution for the dog drivers. Emphasize the activities designed to attract the public, in your newspaper releases. Put most important information in the beginning of the article. Put "filler" material (history, etc) at the end where a re-write editor can easily cut it short without omitting anything vital to the story.

REPORTING RACES

It may be worth while to turn in reports from other sled dog races scheduled on earlier dates, if their results can help build interest in your own event. If you expect the winner of a race to come to "Center City", build press releases around his accomplishments. Use unusual occurrences at other races as the feature lines of your article, never failing to remind readers that they will be able to see such events right at home next week (or next month). Provide photographs

whenever possible, clear glossy, black and white, 8X10's. It does not matter whether they show a good team, or even a local team. Photos of children with dogs are gladly accepted by most newspapers. Invite reporters to visit a local kennel for stories leading up to the race.

Now there is no point to doing all the foregoing unless you file the results of your race, location, dates, sponsors' name. In addition, give trail length and detail of conditions for each event. Then, IN ORDER OF FINISH, list driver's name, number of dogs, hometown, time and money won. The report may be completed by telling briefly of any amusing or exciting occurrences during the races. The results of any other contests should also be reported.

MOVIES. Obtain films of races, training etc., from competent photographers. Offer these films to schools, fraternal organizations, boy scouts, Chamber of Commerce, breed and obedience dog clubs, business clubs etc. An informed person should be on hand to narrate films.

PARADE, GAMES, EXHIBITIONS. The club should obtain names of all members interested in taking part in such exhibitions. Stress to club members that they will personally receive publicity and potential puppy sales from taking part in these events. Dog teams, with wheeled sleds, are a great attraction in Christmas parades, or any holiday parades. Here is a fine opportunity for the owners of novice or pleasure teams to take part in club affairs. It is almost always necessary to restrain the dogs on leash in a parade, and the less ambitious teams are most desirable. When members balk at driving their dogs in parades, it is almost as effective to set up the team and sled on a trailer or long truck bed, with the dogs tied in place and large club banners decorating the float.

POSTERS Ask club members to distribute race posters in their own neighborhoods. These are to be displayed in windows or on bulletin boards. Most businessmen are willing to put up posters if they are asked by a regular customer. Ideally, in a small town, saturate the town with posters.

WINDOW DISPLAYS. If a vacant store can be rented at a reasonable price, a window display may be set up with sled, harnesses, photographs and trophies. A dummy in parka and snow boots is easy to set up, driving a dog sled. Include large posters. Use your imagination.

BOOTHS, ETC. Displays at dog shows, fairs and other summer events may reap great rewards, especially if the club offers something for sale. It may seem unlikely - but the racing club can sell buttons, pennants and other sled dog racing souvenirs in JULY and AUGUST at local fairs.

STATE TOURIST AND RESORT ASSOCIATIONS. Send your race dates and other information WHEN DATES ARE DEFINITE. Allow at least three months for most organizations. Their publication deadlines come early. In this category are travel magazines published by oil companies, insurance companies, large travel bureaus etc. You must have information well ahead of time. Your club should decide upon dates during the summertime. Late charges are to be avoided if at all possible.

PUBLICITY PACKET When a sponsor has shown willingness to promote a sled dog race and is ready to work on it, the club should provide all possible help in the form of articles, photographs, stories about the various dog breeds, past race records, history, "suggestions for spectators", how races are run, and other information that will be useful to the sponsor. It is hoped that the sponsor will then compose articles for local publicity, based on this material.

BUTTONS, INSIGNIA AND DECALS. Many companies will reproduce an official club crest or emblem in any number of forms. Club members should be urged to order and display these items. Your won town probably has someone who will do the work at a reasonable price. Use the local craftsmen if possible. Buttons are most readily saleable at races. Other items are most appealing to club members and will publicize the sport year round.

IV. PUBLICITY AT THE RACE

A good announcer is a must. The publicized race must have a public address system and a qualified person who can keep up interest by describing and talking about what is happening. Walkie-talkie, or action communication from various checkpoints on the trail is worth while if the checkpoint times can be posted to keep the crowd interested during the running of the race. The announcer should be prepared to talk constantly about location of rest rooms, availability of programs or booklets, upcoming events, refreshment stand, how to contact new members for the club, stories about the dog mushers, dog driving anecdotes, etc.

CLUB BOOKLETS

Larger clubs should consider publishing, annually, a booklet which can be sold independently of the regular race program. This booklet should contain an explanation of sled dog racing, a condensed collection of racing rules and timing procedures, photos, drawings of equipment, a discussion of different breeds of dogs used in racing, etc. Names and address of club officers should be included, as well as advertising from local kennels and manufacturers of equipment, dog food, etc. Advertising will probably pay for printing costs, as well as giving the booklet buyer sources of information and goods. Typically, such booklets are sold at \$1.00, independently of the regular race program. The key to success is having plenty of salesmen on hand at the races. Children of club members are excellent salesmen. Booklets of this kind are the best method of educating the public about racing, and interesting a certain percentage beyond merely attending one race.

BEHAVIOR OF CLUB MEMBERS AND ENTRANTS AT RACES

All your good publicity can go down the drain if the crowd sees a participant mistreating his dogs. Carefully police your members in the treatment of dogs.

INSTANT REPORTING AT RACE SITE.

Have a blackboard, or other large bulletin board, on which times and placings are kept up to date. It is amazing how many completely uninformed, ignorant people are interested in following the teams' progress by this means, even if they don't recognize any of the teams or drivers.

VISIBILITY

The race trail should be laid out, if practical, so that spectators can see a good part of the race. If this is impossible, other attractions should be provided to hold the crowd while teams are out on the trail. These might include:

Weight pulling contest	Sno-shoe Basketball game
Disc-jockey or Celebrity Race	Scramble Race
Auction of donated items or husky pup, etc	Driver Introductions in next class

V. MISCELLANEOUS

Please refer to other parts of the race manual for money-raising activities which also involve publicity. No money-raising effort should be undertaken without equal emphasis being placed on publicity at the same time.

Although the club treasury is not benefited in the process, no publicity idea will succeed quite as well as the CHARITY RACE. The club may choose to donate its profits to the Humane Society, Guide Dogs for the Blind, Cornell University, or many other institutions involved with the welfare or training of dogs. An extremely successful sled dog race, which incurred much publicity because of its intent, was the Bonnie Stewart Benefit Race in Michigan. Over \$800 was donated to the Leukemia Research Fund from this race. Club members circulated through the crowd with cans to collect donations and the proceeds from the refreshment stand were donated to the cause. Businesses in town contributed directly to the fund. Dog racers received no prize money or trophies; entry fees were donated to the fund. Sled dog racing received a special boost, improving the "image", and publicity was excellent inasmuch as a good cause will always attract attention. Any sled dog club could well consider holding at least one such event per year; making the dog drivers

appear "good guys" in this way is well worth the loss of income to the dog drivers and the club. Most club members would agree with, and help out if the plan is properly presented.

Attendance of dog teams or individual dog owners at children's hospitals, convalescent homes, and other institutions, has proven to be of great value to sled dog clubs. Sometimes the appearance of only one or two persons, with a dog apiece, is sufficient to "make news" and give the children, old people or convalescent servicemen a pleasant experience. Volunteers should plan to take friendly dogs, clean and well-mannered, and to talk freely and patiently about sled dog racing, dogs in general, and any other subjects their hosts may bring up. Publicity releases should be given out AFTER the event, with headings such as "Sled Dogs Make Olive Hill Kids Feel Huskier". Early publicity releases only cause suspicion that the club is out to gain notoriety. Such occasions usually prove very rewarding for everyone concerned if the participants are sincere in their interest both in the people they are visiting and in their sport.

All club members should be encouraged to show interest in any writers who introduce themselves, whether staff or free-lance, on behalf of magazines. Urge club members to provide photos where desired, and refer writers to more experienced persons if they lack sufficient knowledge to deliver a good story. Clubs which contact national magazines directly usually meet with failure. A professional writer may have better luck in submitting a publishable story.

Celebrity Races: If it is possible to obtain "name" celebrities for the race, all efforts should be made to publicize their attendance and if possible invent an event in which they can take part. The announcers of one radio station may race against those from another, carrying the regular drivers in the basket. Mere attendance and the "hello" from a well-known personality may be newsworthy enough to attract the public to a race. When it is definite that a celebrity will attend the race, the club should make the most of his attendance in news releases. Concentrate on the accomplishments of the celebrity. Any mention of the sled dog race, its date and location, is sufficient. Take advantage of anybody you can get, including the governor, mayor, police chief, etc. His appearance at the sled dog races might do him as much good as it does the races.

IMAGINATION IS THE KEY TO IT ALL

Any way you can connect the sled dog race, its date and location, to ANYTHING ELSE, is appropriate. Mini-skirts have little to do with sled dog racing - but you can dream up a mini-skirt contest to be judged at the dog race, and you will be ahead of the game in both publicity and attendance. Queen contests and raffles all have their places. An imaginative publicity director will have little difficulty starting the ball rolling if he enjoys the job and applies himself to its consistently. The smaller the town, the easier it is. Imagination and enthusiasm will ensure good publicity.

IN ALL PUBLICITY EFFORTS.....

PLAY UP!

Excitement- Winter Fun - Family Interest - any and all celebrities - children and dogs Big Money (if it is involved) - Local people helping charity benefit (if such is the case)

WHEN!!!

WHERE!!!

WHO!!!

WHAT!!!



SAMPLE REPORTING FORM

TEAM & TRAIL RACE REPORT FORM

Date of Race: _____

Race Site: _____

Title of Race (if any): _____

Total Purse (if any): \$_____ First Place \$_____ Second Place \$_____ Third Place

Sponsoring Sled dog Club: _____

Other Sponsors (if any): _____

Trail Distance: _____

(If several different classes and distances, follow below procedure)

Class _____, _____ Miles, _____ Dogs

Class _____, _____ Miles, _____ Dogs

Class _____, _____ Miles, _____ Dogs

Trail Conditions and Type of Terrain: _____

Temperatures & Weather Conditions: _____

Finishing Position	Driver's Name	1 st day	2 nd day	3 rd day	Total time
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SMALL BUDGET OR LIMITED-PERSONNEL RACES

A race which is being managed by a small club or individual, lacking money to pay for trail packing or other service, may come off well with as few as three workers. One person acts as race marshall and chief judge. All of his decisions are final. He is the only person obliged to understand the rules completely. He must have a firm grasp of what is being done at any point on the course as well as in the starting area. It is almost impossible for this person also to race a team and is not recommended.

To assist him, there should be a trail boss. It is essential that this person be mobile so that he may correct situations on the trail if necessary. He is responsible for establishing the course and conditioning it as well as possible prior to the race. While the race is being run, he may go to the turn-around or furthest-out part of the trail to act as the lone checker. After the complete entry in any class has passed his position, he will move to the turn-around or furthest-out point of the next class, and so forth. Naturally he must have a complete entry list for each class before he leaves the starting area to take his position on the course. He also should be informed of any last minute scratches or entries.

The "timer" is the third party involved. Since he will work alone, and will have complete responsibility for accurate reporting, he should practice his art thoroughly before the race, so that he is familiar with the use of his equipment.

These three people should comprise the protest committee (if required) so all three should understand the rules completely.

When a race is presented with such limited personnel, it is obvious that each person is heavily burdened and must be extremely conscientious about his duties. It will pay off to be very definite in explaining the course, the ground rules, and any potential difficulties at the drivers' meeting. It is advisable to have the meeting well before starting time, issuing numbers and starting positions at the meeting, so that such activities will not have to be carried out when the race management are working at top speed on last-minute details. Contestants must be apprised of their own responsibility for getting to the start on time, etc...

When participants realize that there will not be checkers, that nobody will call them to the starting line, and that the single timer is completely responsible and must not be bothered, they are generally very cooperative. The limited personnel race can be very successful if it is made clear that the overburdened officials should be left alone. Be sure to explain exactly how and when protests are to be filed; state when times will be posted, and ABOVE ALL keep the course as simple as humanly possible. Direct out/back two-way trails are the easiest to handle when there are no checkers except at the most distant point. Other trails should be extremely carefully marked to avoid confusing (with the inevitable comment from disgruntled drivers, "there should have been somebody out there.")

If it is possible to limit entries, it should be done. A race with more than eight to twelve teams in each class can easily become unwieldy unless more helpers can be obtained. It will soon be discovered that it is smart to limit classes as well; everyone will be too tired by the finish of the regular classes to do an adequate job conducting extra events.

The rule, when putting on a limited personnel race, is to keep everything as simple as possible- and explaining it all thoroughly, well ahead of time. Do everything before the race that can humanly be done. Snow fencing, signs, and markers should all be put up the day before (at least). Entry lists should be made up and numbers assigned as soon as the entries close. A package containing number, a set of rules, and a trail map may be given to each musher at the moment he comes up to draw his starting position. If positions are pre-drawn, his starting position or time may be written on the envelope and simply given to him at the drivers' meeting. Entry fees should, of course, be paid in advance, to eliminate the need for someone to collect them at the drivers' meeting or race site. By doing as many small chores well in advance, the race marshall and his two helpers can eliminate almost all last-minute confusion and present a well-organized, smooth running race on the actual day.

Most duties will overlap. The entire group may find themselves working on the trail the day before the race. The race marshall may help the timer by "marking" the finish of teams. The trail boss, as well as being checker, will "sweep" the course after all teams have passed him, even following the last team of each class to the finish line if necessary, before taking up position for the next class.

Unless radio equipment is available (and it frequently is not), many responsibilities will fall upon the trail boss or single checker. Be prepared for situations in which the complete entry, as listed does not pass the checkpoint. The answer should suit the individual situation; if it seems advisable to go and search for a team that has not appeared after a suitable interval (usually the length of time it took for the first teams to reach the checker, after the start, following the passage of the time it took for the first teams to reach the checker, after the start, following the passage of the last checked team) the trail boss may wish to retrace the outward-bound trail. Such situations never provide an ideal solution, but are unavoidable in races with so few officials.

Keep cool; make it clear that no questions will be answered at the course except those of emergency nature, until after completion of a class. And above all, plan well ahead so that the contestants know all they must know to complete the course properly. Urge those who are not sure that they can complete the course, NOT TO RUN AT ALL. Stress that the timer must not be bothered; stress that there will be no help along the trail. Being very careful about where and how the course is laid, and being very thorough in explaining the situation to the drivers, will probably insure a smoothly - run race. Accidents and annoyances only come about when there is not enough planning or organization, no matter how small the personnel list may be.

THE MIDDLE - SIZED RACE

When more persons are available, assuming there are already a RACE MARSHALL, TIMER and TRAIL BOSS, it is sensible to assign them in roughly the following ways:

To the RACE MARSHALL, assign a RUNNER. This person is to call teams to the start line, carry necessary messages to the timer or announcer, etc...

To the TIMER, assign an ASSISTANT TIMER, to check figures and "mark" as incoming teams cross the finish line.

To the TRAIL BOSS, assign as many CHECKERS as can be transported to the possible "trouble spots" along the course.

Appoint an ANNOUNCER, if there is sound equipment, to keep the drivers and spectators informed about what is going on.

Assign a PROPERTIES MAN, do distribute and collect numbers before and after the race. This person may be delegated to give out other information, like rules sheets, programs, etc...

A CHIEF JUDGE is an excellent assist to a race - but only if he has a thorough knowledge of sled dog racing, and a good understanding of the trail at this race.

A MARKING COMMITTEE (one to three persons) can be appointed to inspect teams, do marking of dogs, and pass on equipment safety.

A PARKING OFFICIAL can be delegated to solve parking problems, keep areas clear for musher parking etc... In most cases, a single person doing this job is better than a number of people who might give conflicting instructions or have differing ideas about who is entitled to enter the participants' parking area.

A second timer's assistant may be assigned the job (only) of posting confirmed times on a bulletin board as double - checked times become available.

CHAMPIONSHIP RACES

For a large event, all the above personnel will be necessary, plus:

HANDLERS on stand-by to help teams to the line which don't have adequate help of their own.

POLICE for traffic control, both in parking areas and at road crossings or other populated spots along the trail.

ROVING TRAIL HELP to correct damaged or obscured markers, pre-pack trails in drifting or soft spots, etc...

INFORMATION DESK to assist or control photographers, reporters, public inquiries, lost children or dogs and the like.

VETERINARIAN.

JUDGE'S COMMITTEE - one or two other knowledgeable persons to assist the Chief Judge in decisions. This may also be called the "Protest Committee".

DUTIES

Race Marshall- Chief Judge - Timers: as designated in past ISDRA race kit. (See under following copy headed "Officials & Responsibilities" . Some officials' duties should be readily understood without any further explanation. A parking official should understand the layout of the parking area and should be available all day of each day of a race, to perform his duties. Nobody should be appointed if he cannot be trusted to fill the position at all times during the duration of the events and for as many hours before start time and after the finish as may be required. It is better to substitute signs, sawhorses and ropes than appoint a person to supervise parking who will not appear in time to do his job, and will consequently leave the parking area entirely unattended and unmarked. Reliability and willingness to work hard (at the expense of missing most of the fun of a race) are the most important attributes of any personnel.

CHECKERS. Again, it is better to leave a corner unattended, than to have a checker at the corner who is not familiar with the trail, who does not check the teams as they pass or who cannot be trusted to stay at the corner throughout the race. The duties of the checkers are simply:

To ensure that all teams entered in the race pass the point at which he is checking, IN THE RIGHT DIRECTION: to assist intelligently when help is required; and in some major races, to note the times at which all the teams have passed the checkpoint and report them to the officials at the finish line.

REGARDLESS OF WHEATHER OR NOT A CHECKER IS STATIONED AT A CERTAIN POINT ON THE TRAIL, CLEAR TRAIL MARKINGS SHOULD EXIST AT THAT POINT and all other critical portions of the trail.

All checkers should understand the trail, especially the portion at which they will be stationed, before they are dropped or stationed at their stand. The trail boss should accompany checkers to their station if possible, point out the proper traveling direction, and specify whether or not the checker is apt to see teams moving in the vicinity at any time other than when they are passing his checkpoint. Checkers should not have an accurate entry list for each class, with racing numbers noted alongside each name. Teams should be checked as they pass, preferable with the time they passed. In emergencies, checkers should be instructed to assist only if asked by the driver, and it should be emphasized that they are NOT TO TOUCH THE DOGS in an ordinary emergency (wrong turn, tangle, etc.) If asked to take over a dog dropped from a team, the checker should be instructed to note the driver's number and mark the driver "disqualified". He may return the dog to the driver on the latter's return past the checkpoint "if the race rules allow such a team to continue" but the disqualification stands. The passing of a loose team should be noted and mention of from which direction it came, at what time. Checkers should be prepared to stop and tie loose teams if possible to do without jeopardizing their safety, or the efficiency of their work. A checker should never leave his post to catch a team, a dog or for any other reason. The results of a protest MAY HINGE on his record of the times and orders in which teams passed his station. The checker should be stationed close to, but just off, the racing trail, and directed to make no sudden moves when a team is approaching and he is clearly visible to the dogs. He should stand to the on-coming side of an intersections, not behind it

(arm-waving and trail-blocking by a checker is of no use in turning a team back onto the proper trail if it bolts; the checker's stance should indicate that a turn is coming up, not that one has just been missed.

HANDLERS. If a trail has difficult road crossings or other difficult points, handlers should be assigned to assist in these areas at the club's option. They should wear vests, armbands or other markings to differentiate them from spectators. They should be instructed never to approach a team unless the driver indicates that he wishes help, and never to grab at any dogs on the team. They should be prepared to take hold of the sled the instant trouble is imminent, should know how to use the brake on a dog sled, and should be positioned in such a way that they are close to where the sled will be when a team stops or begins to turn the wrong direction at such a difficult spot. Most drivers resent highly having a stranger rushout and take hold of dogs or lines, besides this action being contrary to racing rules in most areas. If three crossing guards are all available to help a team, all three should hold the sled if necessary; **NONE SHOULD GO AMONG THE DOGS EXCEPT IN EXTREME EMERGENCY** (such as if the driver loses his grip on the line and the dogs begin to run away with no control on the sled, etc.). If a handler must go among dogs, he is advised to reach for the towline rather than any individual tugline of harness. (This gives the handler more control of the team and individual dogs have backed out of harnesses held taut.)

Drivers must be advised in advance, how official handlers are crossing guards will be identified and what the limitations of "help" are except in emergency circumstances. This is best done at the driver' meeting during the description of the course.

PROPERTIES CHAIRMAN should have his duties explained well ahead of race time, and should be provided with an accurate entry list (like all race officials). He is responsible for ensuring that all numbers are distributed at the drivers' meeting or as soon as a driver arrives at the course. He should pick up numbers after the race at designated time, check them off as they are received, and report damaged or missing numbers as promptly as possible following the race. If he is also acting as messenger or reporter, he should be on hand at the starting area throughout the duration of the race, as should all other responsible club members who have specific duties at the race.

GENERAL:

On no account should the services of anyone be accepted unless the person agrees to appear promptly and remain available throughout the event. Nobody should be given a job who cannot be available to learn his job before race day. Signs and markers are more effective than an official who does not know where the Class A teams are to be parked, or which direction a team should go around a loop, or to whom to report a rules infraction. A timer who leaves his watch with an inexperienced person while he goes to get a cup of coffee is as bad as no timer at all. Finding reliable people, and instructing them properly (preferably with printed details of their assignments) is the key to successful race management. If a race cannot be planned for a certain area without the necessity of depending upon inexperienced and unconscientious helpers, the race plans should be changed and/ or simplified until the event fits the available personnel and vice versa.

Leave nothing to chance. Appoint a person to do a job, and then proceed as if he might not be there, by doing in advance all small tasks that he might forget, might omit entirely, etc. Mark trails as if there were going to be NO checkers (one of them is sure to beg off or simply fail to show up). Paint signs in excess; it matters little if they're not used because of a surplus of helpers, but it matters much if the chief parking officer has a flat tire and spectators are starting to pour into the holding area looking for parking places. Double-check with all critical personnel to amke sure that such things as starting chute material, latrines, refreshment trucks, tables, loudspeakers, etc., have been obtained.

Who does all this double-checking? The Race Marshall, who is responsible for seeing that everyone else is doing his duty. His job may start months before the race and he may still be cleaning up details weeks after it is over. A good, hardworking race marshall will "make" a race. See that your club selects one... if there is any choice.

OFFICIALS & RESPONSIBILITIES

RACE MARSHALL:

The Race Marshall is appointed by and reports to the race giving club, but has complete and full charge and responsibility for the race; from the time it starts through its completion.

All other officials report directly to him and are responsible to him in all matters.

He has the final word, and the power to cancel or stop the race under extenuating circumstances of weather or trail conditions - can disqualify or refuse teams at the start at his discretion.

He must be an experienced, capable and responsible expert in the sport of dog racing.

He will chair the drivers' meeting, officials' meeting and Protest Committee.

TIMER:

The Timekeeper is responsible for the recording of the time made by all teams during the race. He may have an assistant known as a "recorder". He is responsible to the race marshall. It is his responsibility to use proper and adequate chronographs for this purpose, and be completely familiar with their use. He shall act on the protest committee.

CHIEF JUDGE:

The Chief Judge shall report and be responsible to the race marshall. He shall be in charge of the judges, the dog marker and his assistants. He shall deal directly with all drivers and will receive any protests or complaints. He shall be in charge of the starting and finish line, and remain at this position during all heats of the race. He will cause to be examined teams at the start and finish and has the power to disqualify dog unfit to run in his opinion.

TRAIL BOSS:

The Trail Boss shall report directly to the race marshal and is responsible for the laying out, preparation of, and marking of the race trail.

He should be familiar with the requirements of a race trail suitable for dog teams and do his utmost to prepare a trail that will not have dangerous corners, road crossings, etc., that can be hazardous to dogs and driver.

He is responsible for patrolling the race trail during the race, and placing the trail stewards at locations as may be required.

Protest Committee: Race Marshall, Chief Judge and Time Keeper

PROTEST MEETING PROCEDURE

I. **PROTEST COMMITTEE MEMBERSHIP:** All protests submitted in writing should be considered by a Protest Committee, preferable consisting of three members. Normally, the Race Marshall will chair this committee and other members will be the Chief Judge and one other race official who may be the timer, another judge or a trail official. All should have experience in race officiating or sled dog driving and all should know the race rules used for the race. None should be a driver or close relative of a driver in the race.

II. **MEETING NOTIFICATION:** As soon as a written protest has been submitted, the Chief Judge shall notify the person designated to act as Protest Committee Chairman and either one shall then set a time and place for hearing the protest and all concerned shall be immediately notified. They are the rest of the committee, the protestor and the person protested.

III. **DECISION TO HEAR PROTEST:** The chairman shall convene the meeting and take up all protests files, usually in the order in which received by the Chief Judge. First it must be ascertained whether the protest was filed within the time limits and other conditions prescribed by the race rules, or whether sufficient circumstances exist to warrant proceedings. If neither of these conditions exist, then the protest is not read or considered and it is "disallowed".

IV. **PROTESTOR EXPLANATION:** Protests which are to be heard are then read to the committee, usually by the Chief Judge. The protestor is then asked to explain his protest in more detail and is then asked to answer any questions the committee member may have.

V. **REBUTTAL:** Then the person protested is asked to present his statement of what happened and may also be asked questions by the committee. If any valid witnesses to the incident can be presented by either the protestor or the person protested against, they may be presented to the committee for statements.

VI. **COMMITTEE DECISION:** Both protestor and person protested are asked to leave the room while the committee decides, by a vote if necessary, whether to:

- a. Disallow the protest.
- b. Agree with the protestor that the person protested violated the race rules and then either:
 1. Reprimand the person protested (usually verbally but can be done in writing or,
 2. Disqualify the person protested.

VII. **DECISION NOTIFICATION:** The two people involved are then notified of the committee decision and the reasons for that decision, and the Timer is notified of any disqualifications.

NOTE: Protest Meetings should be held in private; the chairman should exercise control over who is allowed to speak and the protestor and person protested should normally not be allowed to argue the case between themselves. If necessary, to keep tempers from flaring, each can make his statement before the committee with the other absent.

Time penalties are not allowed under ISDRA rules. Fair computation is almost impossible, and their use can give mushers the feeling that it is okay to break a rule, as even if protested, all you do is lose a little time. Reprimands should not be given rather than a disqualification solely because a team came from a long distance and might not come back if disqualified. If the evidence is clear that a rule was broken and either provided an advantage to the person protested or was disadvantageous to the protestor, the **DISQUALIFICATION** is a committee's **ONLY COURSE**.

ONLY BY FAIR DISQUALIFICATION WILL RESPECT FOR RULES AND OFFICIALS BE GAINED.

TIMING MAJOR SLED DOG RACES

By Glenn Bordwell

PERSONNEL: Since the Timekeepers are the brain, the heart and the actuating element of the entire operation, they will be discussed first. Just finding personnel with spare time available, and willing to devote that time is something of a problem. A good timer or timekeeper must possess certain traits, most important among them being emotional stability, mental acuity, good eyesight and hearing. When these criteria are impressed upon those already mentioned, the number of person eligible and acceptable to serve as timers and/or timekeepers is drastically reduced.

ENVIRONMENT: To do accurate and acceptable work the timing area must be provided with working quarters that assure unrestricted visibility of the start and finish area, adequate protection from interference, a means of communicating with other race officials, and last but not least, a minimum degree of personal comfort.

EQUIPMENT: Timing instruments - Most acceptable from the author's standpoint are standard 23 line size, pocket type watches of railroad quality and with sweep second hand. The "spring and escapement" style of watch has been developed to a remarkable degree of accuracy. Its operation is more nearly independent of external influences than any other movement, with the possible exception of the Accutron which, at the present time, is available only in the wrist model. Electronic watches employing an escapement mechanism are also wrist size and provide little, if any, advantage over the escapement type watches.

Electric timers, of large watch or clock size, are usually driven by external sources, either 115/230V AC domestic power or by some form of battery, usually 6-12V DC. Any variation in domestic AC power voltage or frequency affects the accuracy of the timing device being fed from this source. There are a number of influences which affect voltage and/or frequency of domestic supply. The most obvious and most effective influence is load, the application of which is uncontrollable. More important of consideration is the possibility of even a momentary complete loss of power. Batteries can supply very even voltage and since the current is DC, the difficulty of frequency is eliminated. However, unless attached to a charger, the battery deteriorates at a constantly accelerating rate. Further, the battery is affected by its environmental conditions; i.e. temperature, pressure, etc.

At least three synchronized time pieces should be utilized, and the author frequently utilizes as many as five.

The timing area should have available a good set of binoculars.

Each person should have a clip board large enough to hand the "time record sheet". He or she should also be provided with a scratch pad and several sharpened pencils for computations, etc.

Previously prepared record and work sheets are a must, and samples of each are included. A public address system with a Push to talk "mike" accessible only to the timing crew is highly desirable.

Races of more than 20 miles and/or more than 20 entrants will consume enough time to justify having some refreshment, for instance, a jug of coffee and some sandwiches.

PROCEDURES:

1. Pre Race:

A. Drawing: The timer and one or more of the timekeepers, along with the secretary of the sponsoring club or association, should be present at the drawing to record the order of start, the presence of the actual operating officials does much to instill confidence in the participants. Though usually a somewhat hurried affair, the timing officials at least see each participant and this is an aid to rapid identification during the race.

If there are any questions in the minds of the participants as to how the race will be timed, they can be cleared up at this time.

B. Scratches: Once the drawing is over, the timing crew prepares the "Time Record Sheets". Each participant is listed in order of the drawing. No adjustment of the schedules should be permitted; i.e. there should be no reassignment of numbers nor shifting of positions. The question of pre-race scratches will arise. This situation should be handled as follows: the entrant's name should be lined out all the way across the record sheet and the word "scratch" written across dogs and increment columns. The number previously assigned to this entrant will not be issued. For example, No. 11 scratches. No. 12 will follow No. 10 at the regular interval. Late or post entries, if permitted, will be placed at the end of the schedule and issued the next consecutive number.

C. Two or more heats-Again, time record sheets should be prepared well before race time showing remaining participants and order of start. These should be checked and double checked to assure accuracy of transcription.

2. Race:

A. Starting. The timer should be at the timing work quarters well before race time. Via the P.A. system, he should announce, at intervals, the remaining time before the race starts. The interval between announcements should be shortened as race time approaches so that the interval for the last ten minute period corresponds to the time interval to be used between teams. If teams are to leave at two minute intervals, the announcements should be made at 10, 8, 6, 4, and 2 minutes until race time. All timing personnel should be on hand in the time "shack" (all due apologies to all concerned) no later than 15 minutes before race time.

As a courtesy to other race officials, handlers and spectators, it is well for the timer to give an alert followed by a countdown which will permit interested persons to synchronize watches with official time.

Synchronization of all watches in the time shack should be finally checked in the last few minutes before race time and should be spot checked approximately every 30 minutes for the duration of the race.

B. Actual start- When the first team is at the starting line, the timer should announce alerts at one minute, 30 seconds, 15 seconds and 10 seconds until start. The countdown should start at 5 and be sounded 5, 4, 3, 2, 1, Go, with the order Go corresponding to zero time (exact start time). Each contestant should be given identical alerts and countdowns.

The other timing personnel also have certain duties. One should count and announce the number of dogs in the team, and all should record on their sheets. Each of the others should have a standby watch in front of him and follow the alerts and countdown to assure continued synchronization. Any discrepancies observed should be recorded along with the exact "clock" time at which the discrepancy was observed. As often as every second or third team, the timer should announce "John Doe, wearing number xx, will leave at yy minutes." This permits a double check on identity of the musher, his identifying number and his "increment" (see sample record sheet with explanation of columns.)

When the last team has left the starting line, if time permits, a complete rundown of all starting data should be read by the timer and checked by all remaining personnel on duty.

At this point the time record sheets should have data tabulated in the following order; Column One, number worn by musher. Column two, musher's name. Column three, number of dogs in the team. Column 4, blank. Column 5, a two or three digit number. This letter number is the increment and represents the amount to be subtracted from finish time to determine elapsed time.

EXAMPLE:

Column 1 (number	2 (name)	3(no. of dogs	4 (carried)	5 (increment)
1	John Doe	12		00
2	Jane Fox	9		02
3	Dori Lee	14		04
4	Jim Fish	11		06
5	Joe Blow	16		08

Even though starting time is 1:00 p.m. or 1:15 p.m., or any other clock time, the watches should be set and synchronized to start with the hands at 12:00 hours. Once the race is started, clock time (i.e., 3:15 p.m.) is of no interest to the timing crew. Only elapsed time concerns them. The following details are the heart and soul of this operation and should be religiously adhered to.

C. The Finish. Determination of the minutes within the first hour, 12:00 to 1:00 are read direct. All times are to be read directly in minutes. Therefore, an event to be timed when the watch shows 1:05 should be recorded at 65 minutes. Now since the watches were synchronized to show 12:00 at the start of the race, the hour hand will indicate the number of 60 minute increments that have elapsed since the start of the race. This provides a quick check on the accuracy with which the timer has carried forward his minutes. Example: A musher crosses the line at the time the watch shows 2:21 plus seconds (to be discussed in detail later). The call should be 141 minutes, i.e. 2 times 60 plus 21 equals 141 minutes. Each person with a standby watch before him should verify the finish time call and if in agreement, all should record in Column 6, "141 minutes". If this musher has recorded under his increment Column 5 the digits "12:", his elapsed time is derived by straight arithmetical subtraction -141 minus 12 equals 129 minutes. The 129 minutes should be recorded in Column 7. The timer should make every effort to call the minutes in which the contestant will complete. At about 15 seconds before the contestant crosses the finish line the timer should start his count and establish the correct rhythm. This count will be in exact accordance with the second hand's movement around the face of the watch for example 25, 26, 27, ...39,40,41, etc. All personnel except the timer have eyes focused on the finish judge, who drops his hand at the instant the finish occurs. (For example, when the first dog's nose crossed the line.) Each records the last "second" call they heard before the hand fell. The timer should continue his count until stopped with a predetermined signal from one of his timing personnel. The significant digit; i.e., the one (one) count "forty-one" should be accented and barked like a drill sergeant's command on the exact instant the second hand crosses the point on the watch face. Assuming 41 is the recorded second count, the figures in column 6 (Finish time) would now be 1:41:41 and the figures on Column 7, elapsed time, would now be 129.41.

D. Exceptions. The finish may sometimes be judged to be very close to the minute change. In this case the timer should announce to his help - the minute is xx and it will be close. His count should then, for example, be "45,46,47,...58,59, the minute 1,2,3," etc. Until stopped. An immediate check of all hands is called for to determine if finish occurred in the announced minute or thereafter, and reaffirm the new minute if necessary. The second case involves two or more teams approaching for what may be an almost photo finish. Exciting as this event may be to the spectators, the chances of it being a truly photo finish are indeed slender since Team "A" going into the heat would have had a lead ranging between 1:58 and 2:02 for time of teams overlapped at the finish line to be critical. Don't panic. After all, a dead heat is no problem as far as the timers are concerned. When this situation becomes apparent, the timer designates one aide to catch time on the first team, a second aide to catch time on the second team, while the third checks for dogs in the sled, etc.

E. Shorter races, Another situation requiring a little extra finesse is the case of a relatively short race with a heavy entry, where the first teams finish before the last teams go out. Depending on the size and experience of the crew, two alternate lines of action are available, If a second person with experience is available, he can be detailed to use one of the standby watches and give the starting countdown while the main timer moves to take charge of the count for the finishing team. If dependable help is not available, the proper process is to hold the starting team until the finishing team can be timed. Care must be taken to record the proper increment when a team has been officially delayed.

3. General Comments:

It should be noted that only once has the actual use of the second watch been mentioned. The other case when a second watch must be used is when the other watch fails. Only one time in almost ten years, I have seen a carefully synchronized watch drift time two seconds in the duration of a race. Three watches holding to the second were on hand. In this case the race lasted almost four hours.

Stop watches are frowned upon because the very mechanism which permits split second timing impose a terrific mechanical stress on the watch. These watches fail much more often than standard watches, and are almost impossible to synchronize for periods of more than two hours.

One of the most embarrassing moments of my life was when I was timing a one-dog junior event. Times were running about one minute, fifteen seconds to two minutes, forty seconds. The watch being used was my own and a good quality, relatively new stop watch. I started a little girl and almost automatically glanced at the watch when she reached the halfway point. It was dead! She was almost a minute longer finishing the rest of the course, based on the sweep second hand of the wrist watch. From this it is obvious that she wasn't in placement competition. But! We held her back to rest her dog and allowed a rerun after all the other teams had completed. In my judgment, her second time, about 1:38, was actually better than her first, and still accounted for a sixth or seventh place. Again But! Needless to say, from that day to this, I have never timed any event without a backup.

Although the system outlined has thus far operated with a minimum of difficulty, races are getting faster and less and less margin exists between placements. In fact, this past year we saw placements in the one-dog junior events based on tenths of a second. It is only a matter of time before refinements must be made in both the equipment and the procedure.

Both equipment and procedures are already existent that would permit split second timing, but the cost of the equipment and the massive preparations necessary for their application are presently prohibitive.

THE RECORD SHEET (SAMPLE)

No.	Name	No, of Dogs	Dogs in Sled	Increment	Finish Time	Elap. Time	Place	Prev. Elaps. Time	Total Elaps. Time	Finish Place- ment
1	John Doe	13	0	00	105:00	105:00	6	114:00	114:20	10
2	Joe Blow	11	1	02	109:30	107:30	9	108:40	216:10	7
etc.										

The time record sheet (above) used by this author, for his home organization, Alaskan Sled Dog and Racing Association, is the result of several years of actual experience and many modifications. The illustration shows the general format.

EXPLANATION:

First Column: Enter the number drawn by the musher. Numbers should be entered consecutively, starting with Number One.

Second Column: Enter musher's name. Column 1 and 2 should be filled in between time of drawing and start of race.

Third Column: Enter number of dogs in the team when it left the starting line. Care should be taken to check this accurately, as dogs are frequently dropped from the team after the term is at the starting line, but before the starting signal is given. This is legal. One timing aide should be charged with this responsibility.

Fourth Column: Enter the number of dogs in the sled at the time the team finishes the race.

Fifth Column: Enter as whole minute elapsed time from the start of the race till the team in question goes. The increment for the first team away will be zero-zero (00). If the teams go at two minute intervals, for example, the entry for the second team away will be "02", for the fifth team away will be "08", for the seventeenth team will be "32", etc. Only by accident will a team be sent away early and the most plausible mistake would be a full one-minute prior error. If the error results from the timing crew fault, the actual increment must be recorded and elapsed time calculated from the recorded increment. It is customary to continue the countdown and signal departure even though some difficulty may have developed with the musher or his team, in which case the normal increment is recorded and the elapsed time calculated therefrom. In the case of a team officially held at the line by either the timer or the race marshal, the increment recorded shall be that at which the departure signal was given.

Sixth Column: The exact time in minutes and seconds at which the team finished is recorded in column six. It is obvious, at this point, that some personnel may be less well coordinated between eyes and ears than others, thus resulting in a one (1) second difference in calls. In this case, majority must rule and all timers use identical call.

Seventh Column: Elapsed time, i.e., column 6 less column 5, is entered in column no. 7, again in straight minutes and seconds. If for some reason a person or person desires elapsed time in hours, minute and seconds, the reduction is their own responsibility, and should not be officially accepted even though it could be verified by the timing crew, because this introduces unnecessary human calculation. Each member of the timing crew should individually calculate and record elapsed time on his own time record sheet without reference to his co-workers. If it is desirable to announce time, the chief timer should read time from one record and it be verbally checked in turn by each of the other members of the crew. If a discrepancy occurs, the time should be withheld and the individual with the odd calculation instructed to double check. If he persists, all members should recalculate. If the condition does not clear, the check will have to return to all recorded data. The author has, as chief timer, held a report up to an hour while one individual member of the crew discovered his own error. Unlike the supreme court, there is no place for a dissenting opinion on a timing crew.

Eighth column: Placement is made in the exact order of magnitude of the elapsed times in Column 7. Each member of the crew should establish placement on his own sheet without reference to his co-workers' records. As in the case of elapsed times, the placements should be proof-read. Upon completion of No. 8 for a one day or one heat event, all time record sheets should be signed by all members of the crew.

Column Nine: When a race is of more than one heat, the time record sheet for the second and any additional heats must be made up to agree with the starting order for that heat. It becomes necessary, therefore, to bring forward elapsed time for the previous heat or heats. If this is to be done in longhand, each member of the crew should transcribe his own sheet. It should then be proof-read by the others and initialed. It is customary in my home organization to transcribe one, be proof-read twice, and then quick printed for use by all members of the crew. It is also customary to proof read from original to printed copy by all hands prior to race time. At this point, column No. 1 through 8 establish records for the day's heat.

Column Ten: Total elapsed time is derived by adding today's elapsed time, from Column 7, to the previous day's elapsed time, Column No. 9, and the sum, still in straight minutes and seconds, recorded in Column 10. Instructions for procedure under Column No. 7 apply.

Column Eleven: Final placement is determined as was a single race or heat. Instructions for procedure under Column 8 apply.

Verification of Record:

After each race or heat, a complete recheck of all time record sheets must be made. When all sheets are in complete agreement, all should be signed by all members of the timing crew. At this point it was well to emphasize that the sole responsibility of the timing crew is to accurately record the exact times turned in by all contestants. Although a tie or a dead heat may pose problems to some of the other race officials, it is to be accepted by the timing crew as one of the rare but expected occurrences with no problems involved.

The following illustration is a general format for a work or computation sheet which has been used by the author for a number of years.

Line 1:	#1	John Doe	
Line 2:	:		Time in
Line 3:	00:		
Line 4:	:		Elapsed Time
Line 5:	138:18		Previous Elapsed Time
Line 6:	:		Total Elapsed Time

On Line 1 are entered numbers from Column No. 1 of the time record sheet and musher's name from Column 2.

On Line 2 is entered (directly) time in.

On Line 3 is entered increment from Column No. 5 of the time record sheet.

On Line 4 is recorded elapsed time i.e. Line 2 less Line 3. For one day or one heat races this is the only part used with the entries on lines No. 2 and 4 being transcribed to the proper position in the columns No. 6 and 7 of the time record sheet respectively. For two or more heat races.

On Line 5 is transcribed the previous elapsed time from Column No. 9 or the time record sheet.

On line 6 is entered sum of lines No. 4 and 5. The entry on line 6 is transcribed to column No. 10 of the time record sheet.

A final proof-reading of the time record sheets verifies all previous transcriptions. A final instruction: NEVER ERASE AN ERROR. Always scratch through and enter the corrected figures above or below the lined out figure.

As a member of a timing crew that has successfully handled a major race and whose records were accepted and respected, you will doubtless enjoy a very rewarding experience. A pat on the back, particularly from an unexpected source, may fill your cup to a brim, but believe me, if you have applied the devotion and effort necessary to accomplish the perfection demanded, you will be as tired as the musher who ran the race.

RACE TIMING: ALTERNATIVE METHOD

Advisors: J.M. McDougall
Mel Fishback
Dutch Sprock

EQUIPEMT NEEDED:

1. Two accurate watches with a large face and sweep second hand. Pocket, railroad type watches are preferred, but wrist watches may be used.

OR

One full-hour stop watch with split second hand, backed up by an accurate large - face watch to use in case of malfunction of the stop watch.

2. Score sheets and pencils. Score sheets should be made out in advance, listing names of contestants in starting order, with room to fill in starting time, finishing time and total elapsed time for each heat. It is advisable to track score sheets to a smooth piece of plywood or other board, attaching several blank sheets of paper next to the score sheet to facilitate figuring of times when necessary. A piece of clear plastic cut the same size as the board and tacked to it across the top will protect the score sheets from bad weather. Have at least two pencils on hand.

PERSONNEL NEEDED:

It is best to have three people, a TIMER, a MARKER and a SCORER, to time a cross country race, but it can be done with two people in an emergency. If only two people are used, the scorer will also act as marker. If only one person is available to time a race, he shall act as timer-scorer, and should ask a bystander to act as marker.

TIMING PROCEDURE:

1. Synchronize the two watches fifteen minutes before starting time. Set both watches at FIFTEEN MINUTES TO TWELVE, regardless of the actual time of day. Having all races state at "noon" eliminates much complicated subtraction and figuring. If using a stop watch, set it aside until actual start time, and depend upon the back-up watch for pre-start information.

2. Announce, "it is fifteen minutes to start time", "it is ten minutes to start time", etc., periodically, to enable participants to set their watches to agree with the timer's.

3. The scorer should insert in the "start time" column, opposite each driver's name, the time his team has been drawn to start, if this has not been done in advance. It should already have been established whether or not gaps will be left, or filled up, by other teams when a team is scratched or withdrawn from the starting lineup. If a gap of the usual starting interval is to be left, mark the starting time for the absent driver JUST AS IF HE WERE THERE.

4. Prior to the time each team is due to start, the timer will announce "One minute left", "thirty seconds", "ten seconds", and "five - four - three - two - one - GO!"

5. If a team appears, reach to finish, before all other teams have been started, the scorer shall use the back-up watch to start the waiting team, while the Timer announces the current time from his watch and counts off the seconds elapsing while the finishing team approaches. The marker will announce the number of the finishing team and will say "MARK" as it crosses the finish line. The Timer should immediately mark down the exact minute and second he was counting on as the team finished. This information will be repeated to the scorer as soon as he is free to fill in the team's finishing time on the score sheet.

6. When all teams have finished the race, both the timer and the scorer should subtract each driver's starting time from his finishing time to ascertain his elapsed time. If this figuring is done independently by each of the crew, errors will quickly be found and corrected. Do not release times to the announcer until they have been double-checked.

7. In short races, with elapsed times of less than one hour, there will be no subtraction of hours or second if the watches were set at noon. Thus, if the teams were started at two-minutes intervals, it is necessary only to subtract the accumulated minute intervals from a team's finishing time. For example, if John Doe started at noon, and finished at twelve-fifty-eight, his elapsed time is 58 minutes. Jim Beam started at noon plus two minutes, and finished at noon plus fifty-six minutes and 16 seconds. His elapsed time is 54 minutes and 16 seconds.

8. Timing for the second heat is accomplished in the identical same way. To determine the winner of the two-day race, the times for each heat are added together. Do not turn second into minutes, and minutes into hours, unless teams are very close in total time and figures must be converted to establish the faster team. Do not erase the original figures like "1 hr. 73 min. 61 sec"; write the converted time alongside it on the score sheet. (2 hrs., 14 min., 1 sec.) Note: I wish all readers could see the error the writer just made in converting that figure. They would then understand why it is wise never to erase original figures until the final figures have been double checked.

RACE DAY PROCEDURE

AS EARLY IN THE MORNING AS NECESSARY:

1. **OFFICIAL'S MEETING** - Chairman, Race Marshall. To co-ordinate activities of all officials, issue official badges (nameplates, etc.) if any, and to decide last minute questions such as possible need for delay of start time due to weather or traffic, or fill gaps left by absent personnel, etc.
2. **THE TRAIL.** The Race Marshall should ensure that the trail is checked, going with the trail boss if necessary in case there is any doubt about the marking of the trail or the safety and protection of road crossings.
3. **THE DRIVER'S MEETING.** Should be completed one hour before starting time for the first team. Frequently at major races, the drivers' meeting is held on the night before the race. If this is possible, it is recommended.
 - A. Draw starting positions and issue numbers, if not already done.
 - B. Insisting on attention and attendance, clarify racing rules and answer questions.
 - C. Explain the course with the aid of pre-drawn map. Warn drivers about any danger areas.
 - D. Post individual starting times in proper order. This may be done as the Timer fills out his score sheets.
 - E. State starting interval (suggested intervals: 3 minutes for long races with ten or fewer entrants; 2 minutes for long races with 10 or 20 teams; 1 minute for short races with ten or more entrants, or for long races with 20 or more entrants).
 - F. Timer announces official time to drivers.
4. **MARKING DOGS.** This may be done in the holding area, by the marking committee, while the final trail check is taking place.
5. **RACE MARSHALL** to dispatch all officials to their positions. Timing and public address equipment should be checked.
6. **RACE IN PROGRESS.** Times shall be posted as soon as they are double-checked for accuracy.
7. **AFTER ALL TEAMS HAVE FINISHED.**
 - A. Race Marshall or Chief Judge shall be responsible for collecting any protests concerning that particular heat of that particular class, within the pre-determined time limit for protests.
 - B. Race Marshall to meet with other officials to receive any 'incident' reports.
 - C. Race Marshall to chair protest meeting (if necessary). Time limits are flexible on above, since starting schedules for different classes may require that official reports and protest meeting be delayed until after finish of the last class of the day.
 - D. Finish positions (1,2,3,etc.) shall be posted after all protests are decided.
8. **PRESENTATION OF TROPHIES AND PRIZE MONEY**, if the race is complete on this day. Should be done as soon as possible for the sake of drivers with long distances to go.
9. Final race records should be made up, with copies to be presented to sponsoring club or organization. Copy to be forwarded to ISDRA. Suggest xeroxing for reports to sled dog publications, newspapers, ect.

THE DRIVERS' MEETING

As stated in the Race Day Schedule elsewhere, the Drivers' meeting should be concluded at least one hour before the first teams are scheduled to start in the first heat of the race. It is preferable to hold the Drivers' Meeting the night before the race if possible. However, this is not sensible if only a few of the contestants can be expected to attend.

TIME AND PLACE of the driver's meeting should be announced prominently in the information sheet sent with the entry blanks. Drivers should be held responsible for attending, whether or not their classes are scheduled in the next few hours.

DISTRIBUTE ALL NUMBERS AND DRAW ALL STARTING POSITIONS at the Drivers' meeting. If entries have been closed for several days, and starting positions drawn by a club committee (as is often done in some of the larger clubs) the numbers and starting position lists may be distributed in folders or envelopes as soon the contestants are assembled at the meeting. Mark the driver's name and class on the outside of the envelope containing his number and other information. Copies of ISDRA rules and special local rules may be included in this parcel.

OFFICIAL SCORE SHEETS SHOULD BE FILLED OUT as starting positions are drawn. Carbons of these sheets may be posted for the drivers' convenience in ascertaining their relative position.

THE RACE MARSHALL SHOULD ANNOUNCE THE STARTING INTERVALS AND START TIME OF THE FIRST EVENT.

DISPLAY THE MAP OF THE RACE TRAIL AND EXPLAIN ANY DIFFICULT PORTIONS.

INTRODUCE ALL THE OFFICIALS.

EXPLAIN PROTEST PROCEDURE. EMPHASIZE THE NECESSITY OF PROTESTS OR COMPLAINTS BEING TURNED IN IMMEDIATELY FOLLOWING EACH HEAT OF EACH CLASS, TO THE OFFICIAL TABLE, in written form and accompanied by protest fee if required.

RACE RULES. Announce which race rules are to be used (i.e. ISDRA), which options are to be followed (finish time at 1st dog) and offer copies of rules on request. Ask for questions from the floor and have chief judge answer.

IF FOOD AND DRINKS ARE BEING OFFERED TO THE DRIVERS, it is preferable to wait until after the conclusion of the meeting unless the fare is something simple like coffee and donuts.

BE SURE NOT TO FORGET IMPORTANT ANNOUNCEMENTS PREVIOUSLY UNPUBLISHED, such as when and where drug testing will take place if it is to be done; time and place of mushers' banquet; special announcements regarding parking at the course.

THE DRIVERS' MEETING SHOULD BE HELD BEFORE THE FIRST HEAT OF THE RACE. It is usually unnecessary to hold a meeting prior to successive heats. If positions are to be drawn for both (or three) heats of a race, drawing should take place at the single meeting.

MARKING DOGS

Revised - April 1976 by ISDRA Board of Directors

To help prevent substitution of dogs in races of more than one heat, all dogs entered should be marked for identification.

In ISDRA SANCTIONED RACES of more than one (1) heat, dogs **MUST** be marked for identification.

MARKING OFFICIALS

A special committee of at least two (2) officials is in charge of marking dogs. These officials mark and then record, usually in a small notebook, the types of marking and the number of dogs on each team. Marking officials are usually assigned the responsibility of checking against the record the markings and number of dogs on each team before each heat. This checking must be done after the teams are hitched. They also note the number of dogs finishing each heat. These inspections should be recorded.

MARKING MATERIAL

Paint is the most usual marking material. Make sure it is non-toxic and waterproof. Spray paints have been used but are not considered the best as the sound of the spray can upset dogs - applying with a brush proves less disturbing to dogs. Fluorescent ink with black light to show it up has been used but has proved less successful than paint.

WHERE TO MARK

The simplest form of marking, and the one used satisfactorily in Alaska, is to paint a small blaze on the top of the head or back of each dog. A bright but unique color paint that would be difficult to duplicate is used. All dogs in the race are marked alike. Checking before each heat after the dogs are hitched can be done at a glance. Different races mark with different colors and use different places on the dog. At the end of the season, it is possible to tell all the races a particular dog has run in.

Another method is to paint all dogs in the race in the same place but use different colors of different teams.

A more complicated method favored by some New England races with large purses is to mark each dog on closely contending top teams with a different color code. For example: Dog 1 could be marked with a yellow, blue, and red stripe on the outside tip of the left ear; Dog 2 could be marked with a red, yellow and blue stripe on the outside tip of the left ear; Dog 3 and 4 could have these colors repeated on the right ear. The variety of possibilities is infinite. All of these codes must be recorded individually and then checked individually against each dog at the pre-heat inspections.

Polaroid pictures of teams and/or individual dogs have been used as a backup to paint markings.

THINGS TO AVOID

Avoid marking in places that will wear off or can be lapped easily such as the lower legs. Do not mark on the inside of the ear, on the face, or anywhere else that may irritate the skin or cause the dog harm.

Avoid large markings as they disfigure the appearance of the dog - about two inches long is quite sufficient.

Avoid any shade of color that could be mistaken by the public for blood.

WHEN TO MARK

Marking shall be done **PRIOR TO** the team's scheduled time of departure and preferably **BEFORE** the **TEAMS ARE HOOKED UP**. Drivers will make their teams available for marking prior to their scheduled time of departure in each heat, preferably before harnessing.

Marking is **NOT** required on the final heat of a race. Three Day Races - Marking shall be carried out prior to the first and second heats of three day races.

In all ISDRA Sanctioned Races of more than one heat, the marking of dogs shall be carried out in accordance with the ISDRA "dog marking procedures" as stated in the ISDRA Race Manual (pages O-1 & O-2) and as revised at the April 1976 ISDRA meeting. *This means that marking WILL NOT be carried out after a heat and EVERY EFFORT will be made to mark dogs prior to their being hitched.*

Dogs should not be subjected to the psychological upset of marking once they are hitched and keyed up to run. If the holding area is properly organized, marking officials will know where each truck can be found. Teams must be available by their trucks far enough in advance of the race to give the officials ample time to mark. The driver and/or handler of the team must be available by the truck to be responsible for seeing that every dog to be run is marked and to hold each dog during the process. Marking in the holding area is the procedure used in Alaska.

Marking may be done the day or evening prior to the race at a "marking station" other than the race site. An indoor place such as a large garage or warehouse is ideal. Officials are responsible for informing drivers well in advance, of the time and place of such marking. This system has the advantage of having the marking done in a less hurried and more relaxed atmosphere than prevails just prior to the race. Late arrivals can still be marked in the holding area. Marking the day before the race is a procedure often used in the Laconia, New Hampshire race.

DROPPING A DOG OR DOGS

When a dog which has been marked and officially recorded as one of the team is to be dropped, THE DRIVER MUST SO INFORM THE MARKING OFFICIALS PRIOR TO THE START OF ANY HEAT IN WHICH MARKING IS CONDUCTED.

The dropping must be recorded by the officials.

If the dropping occurs before any but the last heat, the dog must be painted with an ADDITIONAL MARK or have the original one crossed out to make it invalid. All *drop marks* should be the same and easy to spot so that the dog cannot be run in subsequent heats.

TRAIL PLANNING, MEASURING AND LAYOUT

For handy and essential hints, study the cartoon page in this section on the "do's" and don'ts" of racing trails.

The Trail is the Most Important Part of Any Sled Dog Race, Rules to Follow:

1. The trail must not endanger dog teams or drivers.
2. All avoidable hazards must be avoided.
3. Difficult passages should never be accepted when an easier passage is possible.
4. For the reputation of the race, distances should be both sensible for conditions and accurate as described in publicity.

Remember: A Race is a SPEED Competition.

The club, or trail boss, or individual in charge of producing a trail, should be on the course well before any snow falls - studying terrain, checking distances in whatever ways possible, learning where property lines fall, where gates or water crossings exist, and discovering where the superficial clearing and cleaning of the ground may improve the quality of the trail after snow falls. Such knowledge is essential in the later planning stages, when obtaining permission for the trail to cross private property, government land, etc.

The aim of a race trail is to enable the participants to cover the distance in the fastest possible time, unless the avowed purpose of the race is to challenge freight teams under "natural conditions" or create only a "show" with no real test of the team's racing ability. The entire course should be planned so that the largest team expected to compete may cover the distance at maximum speed with maximum safety.

Remember: A trail that is good for the *fastest* and *strongest* team will be good for *all* teams. The unnecessary or even deliberate inclusion of hazards, obstacles, steep slopes and obscure turnings, reflects the amateur outlook of the trail planner who included them.

See "Trail Packing Methods and Equipment" (Section R) for some thoughts on dog psychology that apply to racing trails.

MEASURING TRAILS:

The actual distance of a course is of utmost importance to the driver who is racing on it. He derives no satisfaction from winning a race in "impossible" fast time for the mileage stated. The actual distance of a trail may effect a driver's decision as to whether to enter that class with certain dogs, or a greater or lesser number of dogs. It cannot be too strongly stressed that *trail length must be announced* unless weather or trail conditions are so adverse that to abide by advertised distances would be foolish or dangerous.

Methods:

- A. By automobile speedometer (motorcycle, bicycle, etc.) Use two or more vehicles to cover the proposed course to insure an average mileage that is close to accurate.
- B. By calibrated wheel. Mile-measuring devices can be borrowed from some construction and surveying companies. These are pushed by hand by a walker or attached behind a vehicle.
- C. By topographic maps. This is most practical where trails lie on the margins of lakes or in rough country traversed only by trails.
- D. By snowmobile after snow has fallen. Often inaccurate, should be repeated. Most accurate if the snowmobile travels at slow speeds.
- E. By pedometer. Several test of the distances are advisable, to be walked by several different persons.

TRAIL LAYOUT:

There are very few places where an ideal dog trail can be planned but careful planning will make insuitable terrain tolerable.

IDEAL TERRAIN: Fields, lakes, logging roads, trail (if not too rough and twisting) and summer-only roads and highways.

UNSUITABLE but USABLE TERRAIN: Golf courses, river ice, plowed roads, roads with frequent crossings and/or auto traffic. Bare ground or thin snow areas.

TERRAIN TO AVOID: Trails traversing or paralleling extremely steep hillsides, especially trails confined to woods or bush on steep country. Sanded roads and roads carrying auto traffic that cannot be closed off for the race. Bare pavement and glare ice.

Cooperation from City officials is essential for a successful race in an urban area where the trail uses a large park, recreation area or city streets.

COMMENTARIES on TRAIL PLANNING:

Cynthia Molburg: In many of the larger races, the cooperation of the local and state police is generally available if a large crowd of spectators is anticipated. These departments offer similar services to protect participants and spectators during parades and other crowd gathering events. In planning road crossings or running over public roads, the police department should be consulted to avoid last-minute changes in the trail.

Under no circumstances should a lake trail be made without a solid packed snow surface on the "safe" ice base. Road trails, macadam, should be discouraged unless the whole road can be closed off and completely snowed over.

If there is any question about the trail, as to its race quality and the safety to dogs and drivers, it should be corrected and if that is not possible, the race should be cancelled.

Roger Reitano: Emphasize not trying to make "tough" races; you have an obligation to safety. Should have multiple guards at crossings.

Bruce Christman: The biggest problem in races is, in my opinion, lack of proper trails. The poorest races I have ever been in were because of the lousy trail. Like... had a winding trail four feet wide up a mountain, though woods and return on the *same* trail. Blind curves, trees hit, no room to pass, etc. There was 1,000 square miles of snow, four feet deep all around, so there was no real reason for returning on the same trail except that it was easier to lay out six miles instead of twelve. Courses a big team can't get around are ridiculous.

Mick Booth: A hill trail is fine, and switchbacks are fine, but some of the trails are damned foolish. A good trail gets laid out and worked on a month before the race.

TESTING THE TRAIL

The most practical test for a racing trail, before the winter season if possible, is to traverse it in a jeep or on a motorcycle or trail bike. A trail which cannot be covered at 15 to 20 mph in a jeep without danger should be considered too dangerous for inclusion in a sled dog race. If it is impossible to drive the trail before the snow falls, covering it by snowmobile with a sleigh attached behind it should serve the same purpose. Remember that the dog team does not necessarily slow down on dangerous cross-slope passages as you automatically do in your jeep or snowmobile; that dog teams may travel up to 30 mph on down-slopes and often *cannot be stopped* in time to negotiate a sudden turn away from a danger area.

TRAIL LENGTH

The Open or Unlimited Class race (terminologies vary) generally varies between 16 and 20 miles long, depending on the nature of the race and the teams competing, as well as the time of year. Races scheduled for early in the season (December and early January) are best planned for 12 miles, graduating and distance as the season progresses.

Limited Class races are ordinarily based on the maximum number of dogs allowed in the team (a mile per each dog allowed) with increasing distance added as the season progresses.

In ISDRA sanctioned races, mileages are subject to sanctioning requirements which set minimum distance restrictions.

Choosing a suitable trail length, depends greatly upon the experience of the expected entrants, the number of teams involved and the terrain. Most serious dog drivers will not be interested in running a difficult 20-mile course early in the season when teams are not yet in peak condition; nor will they be anxious to run an 11-mile trail in late February when they have been training for much greater distances. Major races which attract large entries are traditionally held rather late in the season when in addition of a few miles to the trail length my mean simplification of the entire starting-finishing-timing problem. If it is possible to correlate trail length, starting intervals and entry numbers so that all teams will be started before any teams finishes, it is wise to do so.

TRAIL SURFACE

Ideally, the surface should be hard-packed snow, compacted to a firmness that will support a man on foot without leaving a depression greater than 1/2 inch. See sections on trail packing and maintenance.

TRAIL WIDTH

Racing trails should be an absolute minimum of six (6) feet wide, with eight (8) foot width considered practical. Trails should be wide enough to allow for "clean passes" under any terrain conditions.

PACKED TRAIL IS SHOWN IN BLACK. PROBABLE ROUTE OF TEAM SHOWN IN UNUSUAL RED LINE.

LAYING OUT SAFE & SENSIBLE RACE TRAILS: A GUIDE FOR THE TRAIL BOSS

$\frac{1}{2}$

NO

STAY AS CLEAR OF TRUCKS

YES
INSIDE AND OUTSIDE
TURNS. **VFC**

STRAIGHT, AND DEPART

NO
NO
NO DANGER...JUST MAKES
A LOUSY LOOKING FINISH!
START

52A

IF THERE IS A CHOICE, THE
OBVIOUS CHOICE IS THE

YES

NO SHARP
TURNING ON

OF DIRECTION
ON DOWNGRADERS

YES

TRY TO FINISH
TEAMS WHERE
OBVIOUS "TARGET"

A vertical strip of a drawing showing a 'FINISH' sign, a road, and a building. The sign is rectangular with the word 'FINISH' in bold, capital letters. Below the sign is a road with a dashed line. To the right of the road is a building with a gabled roof and a chimney. The drawing is in a simple, sketchy style.

NO

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YES! DOG DRIVERS SHOULD HAVE A



PROPERTY, WOODS AND NATURAL FEATURES

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

PERCENT IS ALWAYS A BOUNDARY

ROAD COASTING...
FLAMELESS BUILT YOUR
WHEN IN GOOD WEATHER...
IN ANY WEATHER
16 MILL DOGS!
FOR TERM TRAILING IN

"FINGERED" and "LAPPED" COURSES: Both are to be avoided and *never* considered for a race which expects to attract mushers from distant area and especially *never* for a classical sled dog race. Dogs, like many other creatures, get bored

with covering the same territory over and over again and are not trained to overcome this aspect of "dog thinking." In such a race, it would not be unlikely that most teams would balk at taking the second turn around the course, not to mention a third lap, if called for.

Fingered course, back-and-forth, shaped much like "hairpins" laid side-by-side, are also to be avoided. Dog teams are apt to "jump" the trail to join other teams. Again, boredom takes over and another dog team, distracted, could cause them to bolt. It is also not unlikely that a leader may "think" he is off trail at the sight of another team on another section of the loop-the-loop course, causing him to bolt for what appears to be the right trail.

The fingered course also has two other disadvantages in that if the "finish line" is visible, the dog team will make a beeline for that point as is his usual course of action on most race and training trails. Such trails also discourage the entry of fast and dig strings of dogs on that the corners are usual short and sharp, making for a "snap-the-whip" effect on the driver and the sled. The only time the "fingered" or "lapped" trail might be conceivable is in the running of a strictly local "*furt*" race within a club group which is aware of the drawbacks of types of courses as it relates to "*racing*."

TRAIL MARKING PROCEDURES

Jim Mitchell

In all ISDRA Sanctioned Races, colored markers are used to designate the course in which the teams are to run. The ideal trail for a sanctioned race would require no marking other than the blue or green "straight ahead" markers at half-mile intervals. However, other markers are often needed and should be employed as specified in these instructions. Such markers are inexpensive to prepare, can be made in quantity, and may be either disposed or reusable. Two basic principles guide the marking and placing of trail markers.

1. Trail signs must be understood by all competing drivers and must be clearly visible under *race* conditions.
2. Trail must be marked so that competent drivers can safely and accurately drive the trail in competition in their first time over the trail.

Trail signs are much like traffic signs. They should be uniform from race to race, both in appearance and placement. Judge your trail marking from the viewpoint of a driver new to your area, running your trail for the first time with sixteen dogs going twenty miles an hour - will the run be *safe* and *fair*?

Making Trail Markers

All trail markers should be either a round or square shape, about ten (10) inches in diameter or length per side. They may be made of metal, plywood, or masonite; paper or metal pie plates are often used. For easier visibility, square trail signs are mounted on corner to make a diamond shape. The simplest way to prepare signs is to paint them with two coats of quick-drying spray enamel. Only *one side* is painted, thus indicating the proper direction of the travel past the marker.

Markers should be attached to stakes or trees at least (no less) three feet (3') above the trail surface. Stakes are more uniform and easily seen. Wooden lath boards make excellent stakes, are inexpensive and present little hazard to dogs or sleds. Special care should be taken when marking a trail with mental stakes so they do not present a hazard.

Dog race trail markers *should not* resemble any other kind of markers. Do *not* use surveyor's ribbon for markers.

Turn Markers

Red markers indicate turns. Placing the Red marker on the right side of the trail indicates that the approaching turn is to the right. A Red marker on the left side of the trail indicates a turn to the left.

Turn markers must be used at all intersections involving turns. In addition, turn markers should be placed in advance of all blind turns. As a rule of thumb, if you can't see fifty feet beyond the turn, better mark it.

Turn markers should be placed about fifty feet ahead of the entrance to the turn to allow time for the driver and team reaction. Turn markers should be visible as far ahead as possible (at least 150 feet, where practical). Turn markers should be placed about six feet beyond the berm or recognizable edge of the trail, clearly visible but safely away from the teams. The signs should be at least three feet above the surface of the trail.

Straight Ahead & Mileage Markers

Blue or Green markers indicate straight ahead or correct trail. Either one or the other color should be used to mark the entire trail. They may be placed on either side of the trail and should be located off and above the trail just like the turn markers.

Blue or Green markers are very reassuring to a driver, especially if the trail is long, complex, or crisscrossed with other trails and tracks in the snow. Use "straight ahead" or "on trail" markers to outline a single trail that has no intersections. Use Blue or Green markers about fifty (50) feet in advance of an approaching intersection which the driver is to go straight through. A blue or Green marker should also be placed about fifty (50) feet beyond *all* intersections, turns and blind corners. Ideally, all Red (turn) markers should be followed by Blue or Green markers beyond the turn, indicating the correct trail has been gained. The Blue or Green sign ideally should be visible while the driver is approaching and negotiating the turn.

"Straight Ahead" markers should be placed along the entire trail at each half-mile point. In classical events, Blue or Green markers at each mile point should have the appropriate "mileage marker" attached to the same stake, directly below the Blue or Green sign or, the mileage number may be painted in the center of the "straight ahead" marker.

"Straight Ahead" markers are the same shape, size and construction as the red "Turn" markers.

Caution Markers

Yellow markers indicate caution advised. They are the same shape, size and construction as the "turn" and "straight ahead" markers used in each particular race. Place Caution markers fifty (50) feet ahead of the caution area and locate them off the side of the trail as with other trail markers.

Caution markers indicate portions of the trail where slow, cautious passage is advised or where passing may necessitate extra precautions. Obviously, drivers of different skills will use different degrees of caution. The intent of the Caution marker is to warn them of a difficult section of the trail which could not be avoided by the trail making personnel.

If a poor section of the trail can be avoided, the trail makers should circumvent it and not use caution markers as the easier solution.

All Caution markers should be presented and explained prior to the start of the race (drivers' meeting) and they should be clearly indicated on a trail map. Reserve Caution markers for the really demanding parts of the trail. Employing too many caution markers may be more hazardous than having too few. Use discretion - don't overmark your trail.

An ISDRA Sanctioned race trail should contain no hazards (conditions that present an immediate danger to teams or drivers).

Class Markers

When different classes take different routes through an intersection, each route must be clearly designated. The ideal method of indicating the trail under these conditions is to physically remove all trail markers not applicable to the class currently on the trail. Spotters or checkers can easily accomplish this in most cases by simply pulling the markers for other classes and laying them face down, well off the trail.

Should removal of the markers for other classes be impractical, one of two methods may be used to indicate the proper trail.

1. In the center of the Turn marker (red), stencil a white letter or number to indicate the applicable class. "U" indicates "Unlimited" class teams and a "Numeral" would indicate which limited class, the number referring to the maximum number of dogs allowed in the team class. Avoid using any other legends to indicate classes.

2. A separate sign of the same shape and size as the Turn Marker may be used to designate class. The sign should be white with large black letters or numbers to indicate the class. Attach such signs to the same stake as the Turn Marker, directly above the Turn Marker.

Whichever method is chosen to indicate class, the turn sign must be followed by the straight ahead (on trail) sign fifty (50) feet beyond the exit of the turn. This sign must also contain the exact same type of class identification as the turn marker and ideally should be visible from the turn marker.

Avoid placing any mileage markers in the vicinity of such intersections and keep in mind that "class" signs are placed *above* the "directional" signs, and "mileage" signs are placed *below* "directional" signs.

Mileage and Checkpoint Markers

With the exception of the final "one-Half Mile Marker" prior to the finish line and indicating the last one-half mile "no-right-of-way zone," markers to indicate elapsed or remaining mileage, designate checkpoints or provide other supplemental information, are not essential but often are helpful to drivers. Avoid any possible confusion with essential trail signs (turn signs, straight ahead signs, one half mile marker and class signs).

Mileage markers should be combined with the Straight Ahead markers, using one of two methods. The mileage may be indicated by a white number stenciled in the center of the blue or green sign or a separate white sign with black numbers indicate the mileage may be fastened to the same stake, directly below the blue or green sign. To avoid confusion with the "class numbered signs," do not place mileage markers in the vicinity of any red Turn markers.

Checkpoint markers should be rectangular white signs with black letters, located off the trail as with other markers. They are particularly valuable to inexperienced spotters and trail crews.

Marking a Vanishing Trail

In some races, trails drift in so quickly that no amount of packing or plowing can keep the line of travel clearly visible. Mark such areas with blue or green markers as required. Do *not* drive solid stakes alongside the trail. Use lath as it will flex or push over if struck by a dog or sled. If lath is not available or is inappropriate because of snow conditions, the trail crew should augment the trail by any available means which would create visibility and allow for the safe passage of the teams and drivers.

Snow Fencing as Trail Markers

Snow fencing, or laths placed close together to block or indicate a trail is often very helpful to drivers. However, snow fencing does not constitute an acceptable trail sign by itself. The standard trail signs discussed in this section of the race manual should still be used just as if snowing fencing was not there.

Blocking of Trails

In the interest of safety to dogs, drivers and spotters, do not use snowmachines or other heavy or solid objects to indicate or block trails. Park snow machines well back and off of the trail. Cars and trucks, particularly dog trucks, should never be used to indicate or block trails, nor should they be directly visible from the trail. Try to find some means of blocking all such equipment from the view of the teams.

Always discuss trail markers at drivers' meetings with all contestants prior to the start of the race. This is especially essential as it relates to "caution" and "class" markers or others used in conjunction with standard trail markers. Leave nothing to chance.

Advisors: Bruce Christman
Dave Walling
Jack Daniels
Bill woods

TRAIL PACKING METHODS AND EQUIPMENT

Methods will vary according to terrain, temperature, snow depth and snow texture. No single trail packing method will work 100% of the time in any given area. It is recommended that a race-giving club keep volunteers on "stand-by" prior to a race even though the equipment volunteered may seem unsuitable for prevailing conditions at the time. NEVER TURN DOWN AN OFFER TO HELP MAKE TRAIL.

Ideally, in areas with good conditions, the sled dog club or promoter will arrange with the local snowmobile club (if there is one) to have the selected trail driven over as often as possible by as many snowmobile drivers as possible for at least a week before the sled dog race is scheduled. It is hard to convince snowmobilers that slow speed are a necessity. Fast driving by a large number of snowmobilers will produce a hummocky, bumpy trail. The race-giving organization can encourage cooperation from the snowmobilers by promising cash payment to their club, assistance at their race events (they are often short of personnel, too) or a trophy donation. Reimbursement for gas, at the very least, will encourage snowmobile clubs to help the sled dog club pack trail.

Snowmobile drivers must be educated to the needs of a dog trail, i.e. that for racing purposes, a single track worn into the snow is not adequate. A double overlapping track is adequate for a long one-way course, provided there are frequent widened areas where teams can pass readily. A triple track-width is ample in most places. Start and finish areas should provide a trail the width of four snowmobiles for a quarter mile or more.

If a club must rent snowmobiles to pack trail, the larger machines are the better choice. A loaded toboggan or trailer-sleigh towed behind a large Polaris is of considerable value. Once a new snowfall has been broken out, a variety of "drags" will help pack the surface. Depending on conditions, these may be anything from truck tires to specially-built triangular log drags. In areas where temperatures remain cold and snow is powdery, the friction and consequent melting of the surface caused by a large but light drag is more effective than any drag which simply disturbs and plows into the surface. Bedsprings are a popular drag, used to even off rough surfaces on the snow and encourage settling of loose snow. The bedspring is most useful when the temperature is temporarily above freezing, with expectations that it will freeze hard later.

The race-giving club which assigns its trail- packing duties to a snowmobile club, or a group of friends who have snowmobiles, must resign itself to the idea that snowmobilers will loop, establish side trails, and unless supervised by a dog driver, will go through or past (too close) areas where passage of a dog team would be difficult or dangerous. It is recommended that an experienced dog driver accompany the party when the dog trail is being set. The more the snowmobile club is being paid for its help, the more likely they will cooperate and encourage their group to adhere to the desired trail and run it at suitable speeds. Do not trust volunteer labor unless you know the people very well and have their enthusiastic cooperation.

Snowmobiles may be rented at prices ranging from (1971) \$25 to \$40 per day. Most agencies which rent them will provide trailer for transportation; insurance is included; tax is not. These are usually the smaller, lighter models.

OTHER TRAIL PACKING EQUIPMENT. In area where snow depths are not great, but there is excessive snow for dog race purposes, any good sized crawler tractor will be of great value in establishing a trail. Wheel tractors are unsatisfactory due to their tendency to set deep ruts in the snow; they also may bog down in drifted or deep snow. A large wheel tractor may be used if a blade attachment is employed to clear excess surface snow. However it must be followed by a heavy drag to eliminate ruts. It should not be used where snow is wet and thin, particularly if ground underneath is not frozen.

A crawler tractor may be used in any place that a weasel, snow-cat or other tracked vehicle can go, AT THE OWNER'S DISCRETION. Different makes of tractors perform differently in snow, whether deep or light. The owner/ driver knows best. Because repair or extraction of a tractor from a bog-down is expensive, the driver should never be urged to go into terrain which he feels should be difficult or dangerous for his vehicle.

Most telephone company vehicles will pack a rough, but usable, trail. These include Tucker Cats, Thiokols, Weasels, etc. If these vehicles negotiate a trail successfully, they will leave a heavily ridged, double track indented deep in the snow. The driver should be instructed to move over the width of one track, on his return trip or second trip over the course. The corrugated effect left by his tracks must be smoothed before the snow re-freeze, or it may freeze permanently into its corrugations which are sharp edged and very damaging to the dogs' feet.

If a club is able to borrow or rent one of these vehicles, it is worth while remembering that the worst problem with the large tracked vehicles is their tendency to "throw tracks", the weasel being notorious in this respect. Repairs are difficult and time-consuming. Steep sidehills invite track-throwing; direct up-and-downhills are not as critical.

In extremely deep snow areas, a large vehicle like a Tucker Snow-Cat is almost essential for setting the trail. This may be done about one week prior to the race, since early packing and grooming of trails in these conditions seldom serves much purpose. If the heavy packing equipment is followed by intensive snowmobile packing, a good trail can result, provided there is no additional snowfall or great thawing. Under thawing conditions, where there is plenty of snow cover, repeated packing is essential. Two days of snowmobile packing just before the race (assuming the trail is freezing at night) may save the race and provide a very fast course. Wet snow may damage the course more than rain, though hard rain may destroy all efforts at packing. As long as snow depth is adequate, the more packing the better. If snow is thin in places and clearly thawing to the bottom, pray. There is no way to make a good course of it.

Lake courses on which a very thin snow cover exists should be pre-marked and left alone as much as possible unless new snow falls. Salting of ice has been attempted but produces only slush (if anything) and generally serves little purpose except to eliminate what loose snow did lie on top of the gray ice. A drag may be made, and if used with determination and fervor for repeated passes over the course, can help to some degree. The basic drag is a board frame, with spikes driven through it so that the ends of the spikes drag on the ice. (Large screws and bolts have been suggested as less subject to giving way and working back up through the wood

frame). The drag must be towed by a heavy vehicle, and is more effective if loaded so heavily that the tractor can barely pull it. The trail so produced will not be good, but can be run.

Deep-snowed lake courses are best plowed a few days before the race, to eliminate duplication of efforts, and then run over by snowmobile. Plowing, if done by a vehicle with a wide blade, is ideal in that it provides a high bank or berm which shows the course clearly to the dogteams. This bank will remain through considerable windy weather which would drift away a simply packed course. It also will, in places, catch snow that would otherwise drift onward, making for soft places in the trail which require further packing and dragging if a fast course is desired.

Before any heavy equipment is taken out on lake ice, the thickness of the ice should be checked by experienced personnel, especially in spring or current areas know to be dangerous. The local personnel are assumed to be knowledgeable about ice safety in the race area.

Where no mechanical equipment is available, and a small club wishes to have a race, repeated driving of the trail by a willing dog-team owner will produce a trail that is at least defined for the racing teams. A large toboggan with a good load will pack a better trail than a dogsled. Snowshoe trails may be firm enough to support dogs, but seldom will support a man.

Plowed city roads, graveled or not, are often part of a good race course. In areas with shallow, packable snow, it may be possible to pack a good racing trail by using four-wheel-drive vehicles, driving repeatedly over the course on different tracks so that the worst rutting is eliminated or cut down. A heavy drag towed behind a jeep during the proper time of day (while thawing is taking place) can produce a good trail.

In any area where snow must be brought in, as on the main street of a town where a starting area may be, the snow should be spread across the entire trail area. Dogs will tend to run on bare pavement instead of loose, slushy snow, if they have a choice. One or two miles (total) of such going is the maximum acceptable to most dog drivers. Bare pavement, no matter how attractive to dogs, will cause foot damage and consequent complaints by the humane society - and from the spectators. If paved areas cannot be completely snowed for a race, they should be eliminated from the course. Dogs do not choose the bare pavement to get away from the "cold snow", but because they can obtain better footing to run faster than they can do when they are running in a layer of slush. They do not have the intelligence to realize they will hurt their feet by running on the hard surface. The limitations of dog intelligence must be considered in laying out any race course.

Remember when laying a trail: if there are trails shooting off from the left side of a curve which turns to the right, the dogs will take these offshoots rather than the main trail. This is typical dog psychology, very simply understood if you picture yourself as being only two feet high and traveling at 20 m.p.h. You will be following the "curb" to your left on any turns, wide or narrow, that swing to the right; you will be watching the "curb" to your right if you are traveling at high speed on a turn to your left. At HIGH speeds, as with professional teams, the dogs will run at the outside of the curves. At LOW speeds, the dogs will be more inclined to run on the insides of curves. With SLIGHT curves, dogs will run as straight as possible (cutting the insides of all curves). With BIG curves, dogteams will be swinging on the outsides of the curves as much as a bobsled would do.

A ninety-degree turn may be safe for a three-dog team. It is not safe for a big team.

A two-foot dropoff from hill to lakebed may be safe for up to five dogs. It is not safe for more. All sharp drops should be shoveled out.

Any trail or course which a regular motor vehicle can negotiate at thirty miles per hour (throughout) will be safe for a sled dog race involving dogteams of professional size. The teams travel slower most of the time - but they occasionally make great speeds on downhill or exceptionally fast areas. The teams are longer than a Greyhound Bus. As you lay trail, picture yourself driving a Greyhound Bus through this particular area, and you will lay a safe trail.

Please study the "do's and don'ts" of trail making - and at all times, think as if you were only two feet tall and traveling at 20m.p.h. If you can't get the feeling, borrow a motorized Kart (which will make you about the right height) and drive it through your proposed course during the off-season. Or rent a snowmobile and try it out after the first snow at the best speed you can make without breaking or throttling down.

The ideal trail for sled dog racing has no icy surfaces to cut dogs' feet; it is packed so well that dogs do not sink in more than an inch (preferably less) when running, and has a clear border to direct teams the proper way for the entire distance. It has no turns away from the trail that seem more obvious than the proper trail; it

has no turns so sharp that a Greyhound Bus couldn't negotiate them at a good speed. The trail you plan for the biggest teams will be satisfactory for all teams.

SUMMARY

The most generally approved methods for trail packing are the following:

1. Where applicable, shallow plowing of the trail to lay up a bank and remove excess snow, followed by frequent running at low speeds by snowmobiles. The last circuits should be done with a light drag (bedspring, etc.) to smooth track-marks.
2. Initial packing by heavy equipment such as snow-cat, weasel, Thiokol or tractor (especially in rough terrain where plowing is impossible and snow depth are great, or not sufficient to allow removal of any snow) followed by snowmobile coverage as above.
3. All-season, or long-term, running by snowmobile, to maintain a packed trail at all times; frequent inspection and repair of rutted or hummocked areas by hand.

HOLDING AREA, START AND FINISH

The HOLDING AREA or hookup area is the place where the dog drivers' vehicles are parked and their teams are hitched. It is possible, the majority of mushers prefer to use their own trucks for "snubbing posts" during the hitching process. Musher parking should be so arranged to allow this, if there is ample space. (see Chart).

PARKING

When the race is started on a narrow space, such as a dead-end plowed road lined by fences or steep terrain, parking the dog trucks becomes very difficult unless considerable planning is done. Most of the time they must be parked parallel to the edge of the plowed road to permit teams to pass from further back in the line, as well as allowing access to official vehicles. Despite the difficulties involved, a sensible parking plan can be worked out for a race of this type with up to approximately 20 entries, especially if the teams are racing in two different classes. Bear in mind that a good-sized "open" team requires a hookup space at least fifty feet long. If parking is planned so that an "open" class rig alternates with a five-dog class truck almost the entire length of the parking verge, the drivers will not have all the space they desire, but at least will avoid having three or four large teams overlapping and crowding together so that starting teams cannot be brought past. To assure that the driver's park sensibly, the race management must walk off parking spaces and mark them with signs bearing the entrant's name. Allow for the largest rig (truck and trailer) that might arrive; give all participants equal space.

Non-essential traffic must be kept out of the holding area. Officials' cars (except for the Timer's car) should be parked far out of the way, perhaps near the head of the spectator parking area. After all participants' vehicles have arrived, it is sometimes expedient to block off the holding area with a car belonging to a race official. A non-racing member of the Club may be delegated to keep spectator traffic out, or if no personnel is available, a prominent sign may be posted.

THE TIMER'S CAR OR TABLE

Particularly in bad weather, the Time and his assistants should have a car in which to work, parked as close to the starting line as possible. If this is not possible, a makeshift table and folding chairs are better than nothing. The Timer's job is a cold, sedentary one. Lay one or two sheets of 4X8 plywood flat on the snow, on which to set the table and chairs. If a steel drum and firewood can be provided for a warming fire, it would be much appreciated. However, other fires must be built in different areas or the spectators will crowd in and obstruct the timer's view.

Place the timing car, table, or shelter in a location which can be ENTIRELY SHUT OFF from the public. Barriers may be set up with signs reading KEEP OUT. In a crowded area, teams may be started from the closet-in part of the chute, but both the drivers and the timers will prefer to establish their finishes at a further-out point to insure that the crowds do not block off the run-out space and hamper the teams' final dash. If the timers' car can be moved after all the teams have departed, well and good. Otherwise it is thoughtful of the officials to prepare a packed area with a couple of chairs at the finish-line point, so that the timers will not have to work on their feet in loose snow.

THE INFORMATION BOOTH

For the sake of the spectators, an information booth should be built if possible. The opened back of a camper truck may work perfectly, provided it is parked somewhat off the track on which teams are being taken to the start line. Mark the booth with a large sign "information" placed high so that it is visible over the heads of the crowd. This is an ideal place to sell programs, buttons and other souvenirs as well as a suitable location for the announcer and his public address system. The large board used to post official times may be placed to the side of the information booth. A barrier should be placed across the front of the booth, or in the doorway if a camper is used, to prevent spectators from trying to get inside if the weather is bad. (They will).

A large bonfire built twenty or thirty feet from the information booth will attract lots of patronage. Be sure to find out if you are allowed to build open fires in the area.

THE OFFICIAL TABLE

The official table may be exactly that - a table with chairs similar to the timers' table - or it may be another camper, clearly posted with a sign saying "Officials Only" or "Race Marshall". Although the race marshall and chief judge may be temporarily elsewhere during the race, a responsible person should be in the immediate area throughout the day. It is suggested that this table be near, but not exactly next to, the information booth. Dog drivers should be instructed AT THE DRIVERS' MEETING that this is the place to which they must come to lodge a formal protest, or report any incidents on the trail which might later be protested by another driver. The person in charge here will have available paper and a pencil, and the incident or protest should be put in writing on the spot, and deposited in a box or notebook kept in a safe place where it will not be further seen until it receives the officials' consideration. This table will also serve as home base for the trail boss and his crew. The person in charge can take reports from drivers concerning ad spots on the trail and see that they are relayed to the trail boss.

REST ROOMS

Some sort of rest rooms should be provided near the holding area. A framework enclosed by plastic or canvas, with a box-type stool suspended over a hole dug in the snow, is better than nothing at all. Portable chemical toilets may be rented in most larger towns and cities. Costs vary with the distance the toilets must be transported, but the current rate for daily rental is \$20 - \$30. Again, a large sign saying "Rest Rooms" may be helpful.

REFRESHMENTS

An area well away from the starting line, but within easy reach of both participants and spectators, should be provided for refreshment stands or trucks. It should be visible but NOT PLACED IN THE LINE OF DIRECT DOGTEAM TRAFFIC. At times a good-sized crowd will gather around the refreshment stand. Place it so that it does not interrupt the natural paths the spectators will take from their cars to the starting chute or spectator area.

BARRIERS

For marking of the starting chute and restricting access to certain areas, snow fence wired to firm posts driven into the snow is the best barrier. It is flexible for stretching over obstructions or into gullies and is easy to manage although heavy. It may be used on portable posts if the latter are braced at stress points with diagonal lets. Good portable posts may be made by the club by using automobile wheels. Stand steel fence posts in the center hole, on a sand or dirt surface, and fill in the hole with concrete or mortar. Obviously, such posts will last indefinitely. For taller posts subject to being blown over by wind, a wheel with the tire on it will serve beautifully.

As well as marking off the starting chute, snow fence can be used to block any dangerous areas along the trail into which teams might run.

Bales of hay or straw are bulky, but useful to serve as barriers. They are superior to rope because they will not tangle with the dogs, sled or legs if a team bolts out of the chute. On the other hand, they will attract spectators who will sit on them in solid lines. In some places this is an advantage; it is not desirable in the starting chute.

Rope, strung to posts or trees to mark off "keep out" areas, is always useful. It is not desirable as a barrier in places where dogs are moving, for obvious reasons; dogs do not recognize it as a barrier, even when hung with flags, and will run under it, leaving the driver and sled to get through as best he can.

Sawhorses or highway-type barriers can be used to limit parking area, hold warning signs along a traveled road near the dog trail or road crossings, but have little use near the chute or on the dog trail, since teams react to these barriers just as they respond to rope: by slipping under them. If many sawhorses are donated by the police or state troopers, it is possible to use them at the starting chute by leaning plywood sheets against the legs of several barriers set in line. Unless the plywood is donated, this is usually impractical. Cheap plastic which can be bought in rolls may be stretched along the inside of barriers in the same way, but should be well secured; once a gust of wind loosens an end it will rip away readily.

SNOW MARKING

To mark off parking spaces, the start and finish lines, and even some wide-open parts of the trail where other marking is difficult or impossible, a garden sprayer filled with dye can be used. Use food dye which may be bought in powdered form in five-pound cans (approximately \$10- \$15) and mixed with water, in warm areas, or with four parts water and one part Methanol Alcohol. The latter mixture is suitable for spraying at about 20 degrees above zero. If it is colder, increase the proportion of alcohol. One level tablespoonful of dye per gallon is ample. Bright green color will last on the snow for several days unless new snow falls. **BE SURE TO USE FOOD DYE, THE ONLY TYPE SAFE FOR DOGS.** For small snow-marking jobs, the liquid food colors available in any market can be mixed with water and sprayed from a small hand-sprayer.

LOCATING THE START/FINISH LINE

No vehicles whatsoever should be allowed within 50 yards of the starting line, excepting the timers' car which should be placed to the side of it with a clear view of the line from the front or side window. The walls of the chute should funnel inward from either side, from far enough back that the heels of the starting sled are within the outer limits of the chute. The chute must extend at least twenty feet beyond the nose of the lead dog on

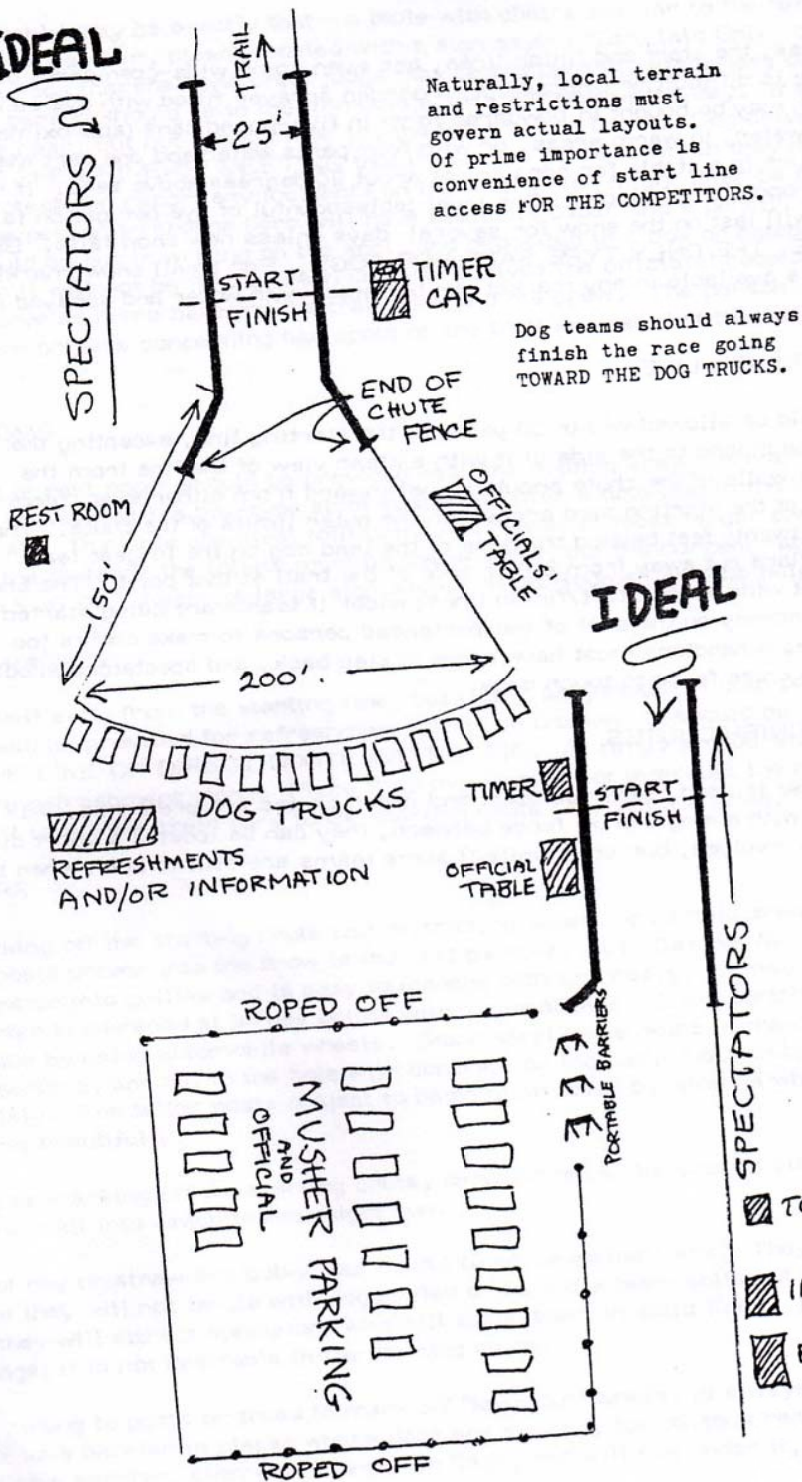
the longest team (about 75 feet) and should flare out away from either side of the trail at the point. The chute should be from 15 to 20 feet wide at the start / finish lines; wider if teams are being started in pairs. There is a great tendency on the part of inexperienced persons to make chutes too narrow. Remember that team handlers must have room to step back, and spectators should not be able to lean over the chute fence to touch dogs.

SEPARATE START AND FINISH CHUTES

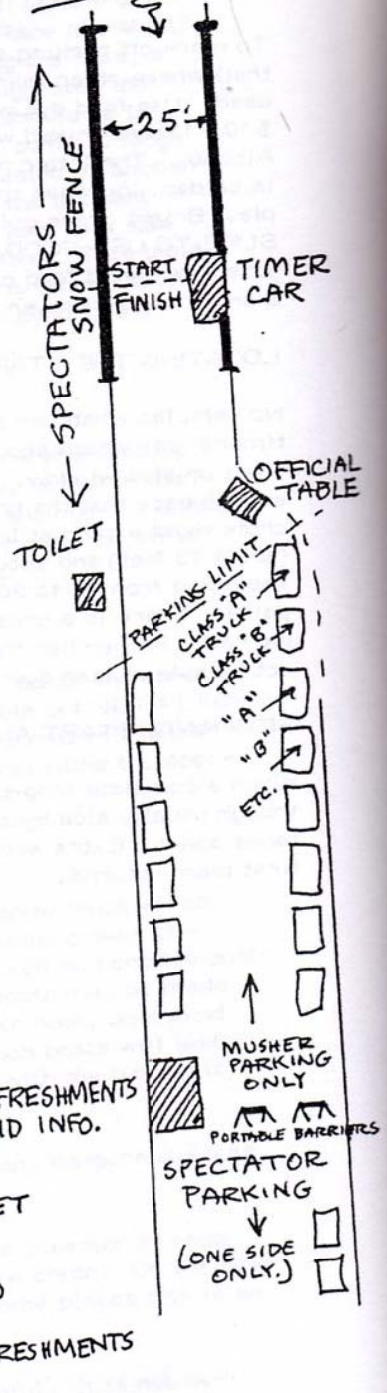
When a complete loop-course is used, separate start and finish chutes are preferred. Although usually side by side with a single snow fence between, they can be located a short distance apart. Extra work is involved, but worthwhile if some teams are still to start when the first team returns.

HOLDING AREA LAYOUTS

IDEAL



USABLE



SETTING THE RACE DATE

The more extensive the race plans, the more important that this race not conflict with another event in the same general area. This means ANY OTHER EVENT, not just another sled dog race. Depending on the location, a conflicting event could be anything from an ice-fishing derby to a dog show or an important ski meet or dune buggy race fifty miles away. Write c/o ISDRA or to any of the national sled dog publications, to obtain dates of other sled dog races.

Do not trust your proposed purse to draw entrants away from another, better established event.

If your date must correspond with a winter carnival schedule, or other holiday week or weekend, you will not have to worry about drawing spectators as much as if you are holding an independent event. However, your publicity to potential participants should begin much earlier, if this date conflicts with that of another race within 300 or more miles.



WEATHER POTENTIAL

Before setting a definite date for a sled dog race, especially one in which much time and money will be invested by both the racing club and the sponsor, contact the weather bureau (if any) for information regarding the most favorable weekends on which to set the race date. Check weather records for as many years as are available. The local newspaper may be very helpful in this respect.

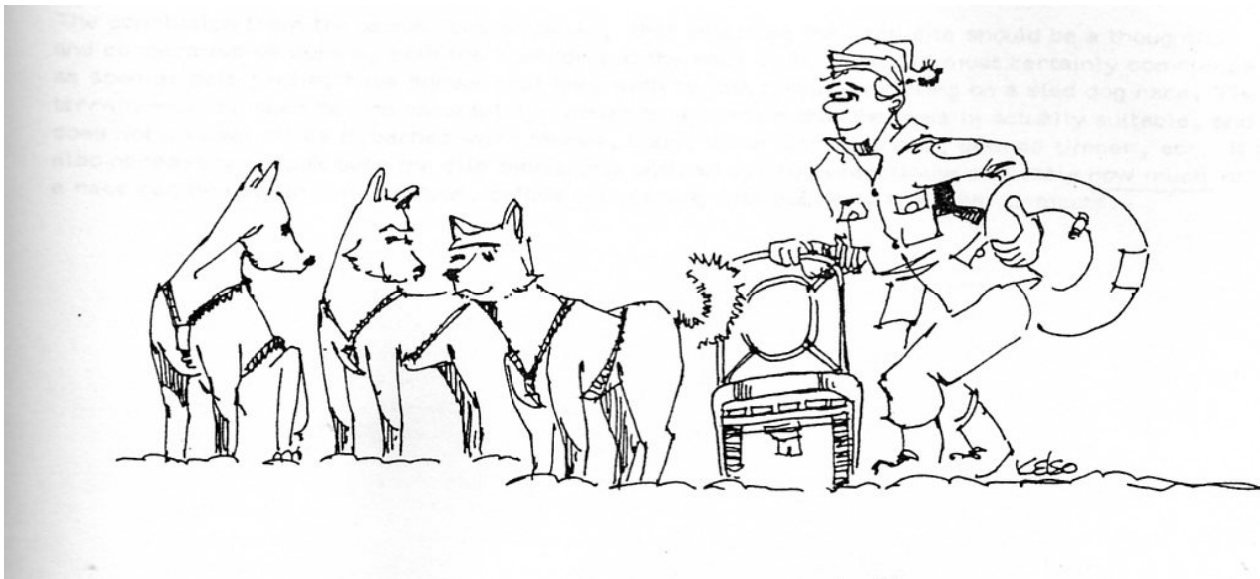
A study may be advisable to locate the areas where snow lies most reliably, if nobody in the club is familiar with the district.

Extreme weather conditions should be noted. Will it be possible to clear for parking if there is unusually heavy snow? Does your chosen area flood - completely or in part - if it rains? Is any part of your selected area subject to avalanche danger? When is lake ice safe for traffic and for how long?

The person collecting this information should take careful notes and, if there is a choice of dates, present it to the sponsoring organization. Careful attention to average snow data will save many cancellations.

If a club finds that no suitable area has reliable snow conditions, and because of local enthusiasm wishes to ensure that a race is held anyway, plans should be made for an alternate course which could be run with wheeled vehicles "IF THE PARTICIPANTS AND THE SPONSORS ARE WILLING". At least, a course should be chosen on which poor snow conditions would not affect the health and safety of the dog teams by having to run on dangerous or unsuitably-surfaced terrain. The likelihood of a good turnout of spectators should always be considered.

Always allow for the worst when looking for trails. Mother Nature holds great surprises in store, waiting for dog race weekends.



SELECTING A RACE SITE

Choosing a location must be done with the cooperation and approval of the sponsor. If the racing club wishes to receive financing from a sponsor, the site must suit the sponsor. If this site is unacceptable for a dog race, your racing club will be glad that as yet no agreements or contracts have been signed.

RACE SITE MUST:

- (1) Be accessible regardless of weather conditions (can be reached by plowed road.)
- (2) Provide adequate parking space for participants and spectators.
- (3) Provide ample space for a properly designed racing trail of adequate length.
- (4) Avoid area which could be dangerous for spectators or participants in and "unusual" winter (example: do not plan parking on ice, in low meadowland, etc.)
- (5) Be within an easy drive of the town or district from which most attendance will be expected, preferably in or near outskirts of town.
- (6) Be located in the area which provides the best possible snow conditions.
- (7) Provide extra open space for special events away from dog trails, if possible.
- (8) Provide as much area as possible in which the public can see dog teams in action.

RACE SITE SHOULD:

- (1) Be isolated from private homes to which the event might cause a nuisance.
- (2) Avoid important road crossings if possible.
- (3) Be as conducive to easy clearing, parking and maintenance as possible.
- (4) Never even in preliminary surveys include any portion where teams will have to run on a thoroughfare which cannot be cleared of traffic.
- (5) Avoid necessity to run teams on paved roads.
- (6) Avoid necessity to run a "lapped" or closely-fingered course because of lack of potential distance.

(Cynthia Molburg): "the public is expected to put up part of the finances - buying buttons, ads, tickets, etc., so give them as much visibility as possible without taxing the racers as regards a race trail... emphasis on 'race'. In fact, I would suggest that if such a trail wasn't possible, DON'T HOLD A BIG MONEYPACE! Such advice may save a club grief and debts."

(Mick Booth): "the trail should be laid out by an experienced musher, not a local townsman; it should be a race trail, not an obstacle course for dog and driver."

The conclusion from the above comments is that selecting the race site should be a thoughtful and cooperative venture by both the sponsor and the race club. It should most certainly commence as soon as both parties have agreed that they wish to join forces in putting on a sled dog race. The terrain must be seen before snow falls in order to ascertain that the area is actually suitable, and does not conceal miles of barbed-wire fences, bogs, warm spring ponds, downed timber, etc. It is also necessary to look over the site thoroughly with an eye to ascertaining precisely how much of a race can be held in this location, before proceeding with publicity and other projects.

PARTICIPANT PUBLICITY

Encouraging Race Entries

ADVERTISING

- (1) BY DIRECT MAIL
 - A. Flyers to be sent to prospective competitors early in season (two to four months before race date.
 1. Include race date, location, optimistic but not over-stated comment about planned trail and prize money.
 - B. Specific race information to be mailed one month to six weeks before race date, to entrants and interested parties.
 - C. Posters and flyers should be sent to neighboring dog clubs.
- (2) IN NATIONAL PUBLICATIONS
 - A. Advertisements stating most important features of race (prize money, trail length, classes offered, dates and location) should be placed in sled dog publications and selected breed bulletins. Ads should be timed to appear in November for January race; December, for a February race, etc.
 1. Insert a small "followup" ad reminding readers of the race in the magazine issue intervening between the big announcement issue and the month in which the race is held.

IMPROVING CHANCES FOR LARGE ENTRIES

Along with specific information about trail, prize money, trophies, etc., the envelope mailed to the prospective entrant should contain the following:

1. Map of general area; easiest routes to race site.
2. Listings of motels which will accept dog driver's with teams. Rates.
3. Information and reservation blank for Musher's Banquet.
4. Entry forms. Send two in each packet; there are often two drivers in one family.
5. Copy of local racing rules or ISDRA rules, if used.
6. Publicity material from Chamber of Commerce (decals, bumper stickers, etc.).
7. Special enticements: (Any or all have proven enticing)
 - a. Free tickets to drawings (winner must be present).
 - b. Discount meal tickets for local restaurants.
 - c. Offers of local hospitality (free overnight accommodations at members' homes.)
- d. Prizes for participants traveling the longest distance to race.
 - e. Complimentary drink tickets for local bars.
 - f. Tank-of-gas refund paid by sponsor upon presentation of bill by participating racer.
8. Race poster to display on truck while traveling to race.

GOOD TRAILS AND DESIRABLE PRIZE MONEY AND TROPHIES are always the greatest lure to the dog drive.

All questions regarding the race should be answered promptly by a person placed in charge of musher publicity and entries, whose name, address and phone number should be written or stamped on all material mailed out by the race-giving club.

Advertise your race in the sled dog publications at least one month and preferably two months, before the event. They should be NOTIFIED of your race, its date and location and planned purse, AS SOON AS YOUR KNOW THESE FACTS YOURSELF. Race schedules are printed in November or December, at the latest. September is

probably the best month to give out pre-publicity; it is late enough that the information won't be lost or forgotten before schedules are printed, but early enough to allow dog drivers to plan ahead.

CURRENT ADDRESSES OF SLED DOG PUBLICATIONS:

- NORTHERN DOG NEWS - PO Box 323, Woodinville, Washington
- TEAM and TRAIL - (The Musher's monthly News) - Center Harbor, New Hampshire 03226
- INTERNATIONAL SIBERIAN HUSKY NEWS - Doris Lovrine, 9436 W. Orchard West Allis, Wisconsin
- SIBERIAN HUSKY CLUB OF AMERICA - (address changes annually)
- ALASKA MALAMUTE CLUB OF AMERIC - (address changes annually)
- ALASKA SLED DOG RACING NEWS - Box 3-2777, Anchorage, Alaska

In addition, the addresses of local sled dog clubs should be obtained, and all information pertaining to the race should be mailed to the secretaries of these clubs. Local clubs, which will supply MOST of the entries in a new race, are most interested in DETAIL (type of trail, length of trail, nearby motels, purse distribution, classes offered, etc.) You need not supply these details to the national magazines; interested parties will write individually to obtain them from you or your club secretary.

KNOW YOUR DEADLINES. Find out when advertising must be mailed to ensure that it will appear in the issue of the magazine which is sent out one month, or two months, before your race date. It does not good to publicize a race which is over before the magazine reaches interested readers.

The addresses STARRED (above) are those publications that will do your race the most good. The first two are nationally distributed and represent races and mushers all over the USA and Canada and do include overseas readers. The last-named goes to people all over the country, but generally carries advertising of interest only to Alaska.

----- SAMPLE FIRST RACE ADVERTISEMENT -----
(Half-page for most publications)

ANNOUNCING! ANNOUNCING! ANNOUNCING!

A FIRST for (State, county, City, Region, etc)
THE FIRST ANNUAL CITY CENTER CHAMPIONSHIP SLED DOG RACES
JANUARY 11 AND 12

ISDRA RACE RULES - PRIZE MONEY - \$2,000.00 Divided among Class "A", "B", & special events
TRAIL: CLASS A - 20 MILES OF ROLLING GRASSLAND. CLASS B - 10 MILES. LOOP COURSE, both classes
BEAUTIFUL TROPHIES!!! UNEXCELLED SNOW CONDITIONS!!!
Sponsored by the City Center Chamber of Commerce and the Central Sled Dog Club. Chief Timer: Joe Watch.
Chief Judge: Jake Walters Emers.

SPECIAL CASH AWARDS TO THE TEAM FROM THE GREATEST DISTANCE, - OLDEST AND YOUNGEST DRIVERS.

ADDITIONAL DAY MONEY to be paid to top three placers each day!
GET IN ON THE FUN!!! DON'T WAIT TO HEAR HOW GREAT THE RACE WAS!

For entry forms and additional information write: Mrs Robert Blank
1122 33rd Avenue
City Center, Centralia

Give as much appealing information as possible without crowding your ad so that it's impossible to read. Emphasize "race site", "trail length", "purse" and "distribution" and "ISDRA Rules" and "ISDRA Sanctioning" if the latter two apply to the race.

PRIZE MONEY DISTRIBUTION

MAJOR RACE EVENTS

1. It is strongly urged that the race sponsor announce with the advance race publicity and before the entries are submitted, the prize money to be offered and the way it will be divided. If the exact amount of money can not be determined prior to the race, then the exact distribution percentages AND A GUARANTEED MINIMUM should be announced.

2. The following principles are recommended:

- A. 25% to 40% of the total monies should be distributed to first place.
- B. The balance of the money should be distributed on a declining scale to approximately one third of the expected total entries for the event.
- C. "Day Money", awarded for fast times in individual heats, should not be more than 1/3 the amount awarded for the total time placements.

3. Even when prize money is paid, the sponsoring organization should provide trophies for all events own through third place.

OTHER RACE EVENTS

1. In a pot race, or other small-scale race, it is recommended that prize money be distributed as follows:

- | | |
|------------------|---|
| A. First Place: | 40% of the total (after expenses have been paid). |
| B. Second Place: | 30% of the total |
| C. Third Place: | 20% of total |
| D. Fourth Place: | 10% of the total |

2. JUNIOR RACES: To preserve Junior's amateur status, whether they want it or not, do not offer any money prizes in the Junior events. Only trophies, medals, or donated merchandise should be awarded to anyone under 18 years of age.



ENTRY FEES

POT RACES AND PRELIMINARIES: From \$2.00 to \$5.00, at discretion of the club, and depending upon whether or not the entry fee money is to be paid out in prizes. If trophies are given, entry fees may be adjusted to pay the cost of the trophies.

Entry fees for a fun race or workout may be established at a price sufficient to pay for a club-run picnic or dinner after the race or workout is completed, or to provide free refreshments during the running of the event.

SCHEDULED RACES: In races where prize money is offered, the entry fee should approximate 1% of the total prize money. Example: The Open Class offers \$800 in prize money. A fair entry fee will range from \$7.50 to \$10.00

Limited classes, which often offer no prize money, usually have an entry fee of \$5.00. Junior and three-dog team classes have fees of \$2.00 or \$3.00.

MAJOR RACES, CHAMPIONSHIPS: entry fees are set according to "prestige value" of the race, and frequently amount to a considerable sum which is used to augment the prize fund.

Important championship races of great tradition and popularity, offering prize money in excess of \$3,500.00, demand entry fees of from \$35.00 to \$50.00 or even more (some Alaskan events). A new race in a new area should not consider asking entrants to pay such fees. \$25.00 should be the maximum entry fee for a big, well-financed and potentially popular event of the "Best in this area" class (considered the regional Championship).

PAYMENT OF ENTRY FEES

It is standard practice in most areas to collect entry fees from participants on or before a closing date (usually about one week before the race) in order that the total amount may be ascertained and distributed into the prize fund or to pay expenses as necessary.

Entry fees shall not be returnable after the closing date has passed, unless the race is cancelled by the race-giving club. All entry fees should be returned in this unhappy circumstance.

POST ENTRIES

If a race permits post entries, a penalty payment should be added to the usual entry fee to discourage the practice of last-minute entry. If this is not done, the participants are apt to take advantage of the club to an annoying extent. Penalty, entry fees range from $\frac{1}{2}$ the original entry fee added to it (Original fee, \$5.00; Penalty, \$2.50 = \$7.50 post entry fee), up to double the usual fee. Post entry should be stated on the entry form.

SAMPLE ENTRY FORM

ORGANIZATION NAME (SLED DOG CLUB)
SPONSORED BY _____ (SPONSORING NAME)

RACE NAME

LOCATION
DATE

ENTRY FEE (by classes)
PRIZE MONEY (by classes)
Paid to what place

ENTRY CLOSE DATE
TROPHIES (by class)
To what place

PUBLICITY INFORMATION

Owner of team

Driver (if different from owner)

Address

Telephone (including area code)

Class Entered

Number of dogs in team

Leader's Name

Recent races won or placed

Number of years racing

Radio, TV or other Appearances

Your most exciting race or experience with dogs

(add details on back of page)

Do you make your equipment?

Sled Dog Club Affiliation

ACTION PICTURE, PLEASE!

I acknowledge and agree to be responsible for my conduct, the conduct of my helpers and my dogs. Further, I shall not hold the sponsor of the race or (the race giving club) liable for any injury to myself, my dogs or my equipment, nor shall I hold the race sponsor and/or race giving club responsible for publicizing the results of drug testing, if such test is conducted under ISDRA rules and procedures.

Signed

Address

Date

MAIL ENTRY FORM WITH FEES TO:

NAME, ADDRESS AND PHONE NUMBER OF PERSON IN CHARGE OF RECEIVING ENTRIES.

LEGAL OBLIGATIONS and INSURANCE

The race-giving club or the sponsoring organization should insure that the race is as completely protected as possible, both with insurance policies and with a clear knowledge of any local regulations regarding use of roads and trails, trespass, responsibility for damage to property and livestock, and too many other local restrictions or ordinances to cover in a book of this kind. A representative of the club or sponsor is advised to consult with a lawyer in the race area to learn about all these matters.

ISDRA Insurance

As of 1982, ISDRA has a blanket insurance policy that covers all its member clubs. It is a general liability policy providing protection from bodily injury claims and protection claims alleging damage to property. It is not a direct medical insurance coverage for ISDRA members but it is protection for them in the event that their activities caused injury to someone else or damaged another person's property. Updated information on the policy is provided to ISDRA member clubs on an annual basis.

In addition to protecting the International Sled Dog Racing Association, Inc., the policy is written so that all participating clubs, all property owners allowing use of their property for club functions, and all race sponsors are also insureds. This means that these individuals and/or groups are also protected from liability claims arising out of club functions and makes it much easier for a club to obtain permission to use someone's property for a race or to obtain additional sponsors for a race.

ISDRA also provides the necessary service work on an insurance program such as this and will see that a Certificate of insurance is sent to whatever individual or government agency requiring one in order to be assured that there is adequate liability insurance in force prior to the production of a sled dog race or other event.

The policy has an exclusion indicating there is no coverage for accidents involving any person while training or participating in a sled dog race. The primary purpose of the coverage is to protect ISDRA members from lawsuits by outsiders or third parties, not to provide coverage for injuries to club members who are aware of the risks involved in sled dog training and racing.

Any questions related to the ISDRA insurance policy should be directed to the ISDRA Executive Director who will answer your questions directly or put you in touch with the insurance agent.

Independent Club Insurance

Most racing clubs with a moderate-sized treasury have found it practical to obtain liability and property damage insurance which covers all club events year-round. It is necessary to "shop around" among insurance companies to find the best bargain.

Incorporation

A racing club of any size should investigate incorporation to protect itself against suits, whether or not a club event carries insurance. An incorporated club can be sued only for the total assets of the treasury. In other words, the other members of the club will not find themselves obliged to pay for the results of an accident in which one member is involved. Any lawyer will explain the incorporation process. The cost of incorporating needs only to be paid once but is variable from state to state, from attorney to attorney and of course, in different countries.

Suggested Questions to Ask Your Attorney

1. Who is responsible for the cost of repair to vehicles and equipment borrowed for purposes of producing a race when it was borrowed by a private individual on behalf of the race? Does the owner have the right to sue for damage?
2. Who is responsible for damage done to lawns, livestock, golf courses, etc., on property crossed by the race trail? The racing club or the sponsor? Does a "permission to cross private land" agreement negate such claims?

3. Who is responsible in the event that a participant, who is neither a member of the racing club nor a member of the sponsoring organization, is injured during the course of the race? Example: a disc-jockey in a celebrity race.
4. If club property or sponsor's property is damaged by spectators or other outsiders present at a sled dog race, who is responsible?
5. For what can a sled dog club be held liable? Where does a club's responsibility end and "acts-of-God" begin?
6. Obtain advice on the proper amount of insurance to carry, considering your own area and its local hazards and character. It is a well known fact that in some parts of the country, people will sue at the drop of a hat.

PHYSICAL PROPERTIES REQUIRED AT A RACE USE

ITEM

1. Sheets of plywood, sawhorses.....Timer's and Officials' tables.
2. Chairs (folding or garden type)..... Timer's and Officials' tables.
3. Rope - preferably colored Roping off spectator and parking areas.
4. Barriers (sawhorses, highway barriers) Closing parking areas, supporting signs.
5. Stakes and portable posts Supporting chute fencing and signs.
6. Snow fence Starting chute.
7. Signs (choice according to needs of race)
 - a. "Musher Parking"
 - b. "Official Parking"
 - c. "No Parking" (Many may be needed)
 - d. "Start - Finish"
 - e. "Information"
 - f. "Rest Rooms" (with or without arrow direct)
 - g. "Timers Only"
 - h. "Officials' Booth"
 - i. "Refreshments"

Trail signs:

- "Class "C" turn"
- "Class "B" turn"
- "Class "A" turn"

Parking sign: individual to designate mushers' permanent parking locations.

8. Numbers or vests for drivers..... To identify teams at a distance. May be borrowed from ski areas.
9. Trail markers as needed..... For identifying dogs on teams.
10. Felt-tip markers or paints (non-water soluble)..... For identifying dogs on teams.
11. Toilets.
12. Steel drums and firewood For warming fires if no shelter available.
13. Trash cans Near refreshment stand.

14. Public address system.

In addition, it may be desirable to have extra signs to help spectators and mushers alike reach the race course. Many dog food companies will mail signs to clubs at no charge. These say "Field Trial" or "Dog Show", but will be adequate if other signs are lacking. Armband numbers from dog food companies are visible enough to use for identifying special events contestants, but not good enough for regular classes and subject to loss along the trail.

OTHER CONTESTS

This listing is arranged roughly in order of popularity among most organizations which sponsor sled dog races. All these events can increase spectator and media interest and are very valuable for keeping spectators entertained when they are forced by circumstances to remain within certain geographic limits throughout the day. Certain events, especially weight pull contests, have created a following of their own and are particularly useful as publicity-gainers.

WEIGHT PULLING CONTESTS: ISDRA contest rules and procedures are available through the office of the ISDRA Executive Director.

Necessary Equipment: Sled capable of safely handling large amounts of inert weight. Weights for sled such as bags of dog food, cement, etc. Fencing. Scales to weigh dogs. Timing Equipment.

FREIGHT RACES: ISDRA contest rules and procedures are available through the office of the ISDRA Executive Director.

Necessary Equipment: All that involved in sprint sled dog races, plus inert weight for the sleds.

LEAD DOG CONTEST: Dogs may be alone or with one or tow wheelers at the discretion of the driver. The course may be established by placing barrels or bales of hay at intervals of about 50 feet along a broadly packed trail about 100 yards in length. The lead dog is required to leave the start line, pass the first marker on one side, the second on the opposite side, etc., until the last marker is reached, when he shall turn around it and run straight back to the finish line. The driver must not go forward of the rear stanchion of his sled at any time and may pull on the sled only to keep it from hitting a marker.

Dogs may be graded on performance alone (instant response to commands) or on speed alone (completing the course as prescribed as fast as possible) or, with two judges using both performance and speed to determine winners.

It is suggested that the first contestant start to the right of the first marker, the second contestants start to the left of it, to eliminate the possibility of dogs following a scent trail instead of taking commands.

SCRAMBLE RACE: Three-dog teams are started, en masse at a pre-marked point, thence to race from 1/4 to one mile to the finish line is a suspended clothesline to which dollar bills are fastened with clothespins. Keeping his sled and dogs under control, the driver attempts to capture as many bills as he can until all are gone. (An occasional ten dollar bill often adds more excitement to the contest!)

STAMPEDE RACE: A simple version of the Stampede Race requires that the driver be in a sleeping bag at the start line with his boots and coat off. His dogs may be harnessed but are held by a helper (not hitched to the sled). At the starting signal, the driver must get out of the sleeping bag, dress, load the bag on the sled, hitch his dogs and race to the finish line which may be 200 or 300 feet distant. All the dogs must be properly hitched in the team finishes the race. A more sophisticated version of this race is as follows:

Goldminer's stampede Race: (1) Each contestant must have at least 5 dogs, harness and chain for each dog, sled, snubline, two-line, tarpaulin, lash ropes, sled sack or other container will be permitted but not required.

(2) Camping equipment and prospecting equipment as follows must be carried: shovel, sleeping bag, frying pan, coffee pot or pail, stew pot, plate and cup (metal or plastic), knife, fork and spoon.

(3) At the start of the race, each driver will be in a sleeping bag at least 10 feet from the sled and nearest dog.

(4) Driver may be fully dressed and wearing socks, but be without outer footwear. Dogs shall be chained on a picket line; harnesses and tow-line shall be on the sled, snub-line shall also be on the sled.

(5) Camping equipment and mining tools shall be distributed at random at least 10 feet from the sled, with the camping equipment on one side of the sled.

(6) At a given signal from the Judge or Timer, each contestant is required to arise from his sleeping bag, put on boots or other footwear, snub his sled, harness his team, load all camping and mining equipment on his sled and run the full designated course and return to the starting point.

(7) Contestants shall receive no outside help with either team nor equipment, and shall be disqualified if he fails to bring back any item of his equipment.

(8) The course shall be prescribed by the tail committee but shall not exceed 10 miles.

(9) Except as stated above, the contest is subject to the official race rules of the International Sled Dog Racing Association which may be gained through the office of the ISDRA Executive Director.

CELEBRITY RACE: Local disk jockeys, city officials, representatives of the press or fraternal organizations, etc., race over a short course using three-dog teams volunteered for the occasion by their owners. The course should not be more than a half-mile in length and preferably separate from any other race trail. If a trail is used involving the finish area of the main race, the timing of the celebrity race should be such that it will not interfere with drivers in the main event.

Outside help is allowed and should be provided to protect the novice drivers and team dogs.

NOVICE RACE: For persons who have never raced and dogs that have never been in harness. One dog, one driver, out and back with timed intervals. Again, outside assistance should be available.

KID & MUTT RACE: For children and one-dog teams. Course should be 100 to 200 yards in length and as with the Novice and Celebrity races, outside assistance should be provided should it become necessary.

SNOWMOBILE EVENTS: Winter carnival committees often wish to intersperse sled dog races with snowmobile events. This should be avoided if possible unless the snowmobilers are under the direction of the sled dog Race Marshal and are limited in numbers so they can be controlled. Snowmobiles can provide some events that are a good adjunct to sled dog races, filling time gaps in dog events.

Requirements: Limited closed-course lap races on separate but nearby course. Events can also include obstacle races and tire riding races for spectators.

SNOWBALL FIGHTS: Several types. May be a "free for all" in a marked-off area, with the last man in the area declared the winner, or a mass snowball fight between fraternal organization or other groups - the group pushed back over the line, loses.

SNOWMAN BUILDING CONTESTS: A successful all-day activity at many races. All spectators are invited to take part, individually or in groups, in building snow sculptures within a prescribed area. These mushers are judged at the end of the building time by the Chamber of Commerce officers, the Mayor, Musher Queen or other appropriate person.

SNOWSHOE RACING: Successful if properly publicized in advance (extra snowshoes are difficult to obtain). Prize money should be offered to build up interest.

OBSTACLE SKI RACE: Contestants must step over barriers, crawl through barrels, drink a bottle of soda at a checkpoint, eat a prescribed number of dry crackers, cover a marked distance walking backwards, etc...

SNOWSHOE DANCE CONTEST: A public address system with music must be available (announcer's mike to pick up music from car radio works adequately in a pinch). A most amusing event for participants and spectators. Pick judges from the local dignitaries.

BEFORE deciding what event you might want to produce, consider the following:

- Space
- Possible participants
- Availability of necessary "props"
- Availability of personell to conduct the contest
- Spectator interest

AFTER you have made your decision, do the following:

- Promote the special event through news media
- Use imagination
- Gear for "entertainment"

The purpose of Special Events is to hold the interest of the crowd which is done through entertaining them or even, involving them.

COMMUNICATIONS

RADIO

1. Encourage local radio station to cover the race, or donate equipment and personnel to provide communication between outlying points of course and starting area.
2. Radio and TV stations may cover race by helicopter if event is of sufficient importance to the city owning such equipment.
3. Investigate possible cooperation by Highway Patrol, State Troopers, City Police and other radio-equipped groups.
4. Local radio clubs (Citizens' Band, etc...) may volunteer services to sled dog race if contacted.

TELEPHONE:

1. In some ideal areas, local residents may allow use of phones to report teams passing check points; "runners" may be stationed at public phone or near or in starting area to receive information and relay it to officials.

WALKIE TALKIE:

1. Useful for short distance communication only if batteries are fresh and kept warm, like inside a "hot" parka.
2. May be used for contact between timers' table and officials' table if desired.

BY VEHICLE:

1. Snowmobile "runners". Carefully instructed persons may commute back and forth to checkpoints to carry back information to the starting area. Must be conditioned to stop when a team approaches, travel only on dog trail or on a route which DOES NOT CROSS OR COME NEAR DOG TRAIL.

BY SEMAPHORE:

1. Limited use, confined to flagging from one watcher to another when teams are approaching through wooded areas invisible from finish line, etc.

SOUND EQUIPMENT

A car-mounted public address system operating off the battery of the automobile has proven most satisfactory at most races. May be borrowed or rented from a local organization, school, police department.

Transistorized "bull horns" are common, easily borrowed, but do not have sufficient volume to serve as announcing equipment at a large race. A bull horn should be provided for the head Timer to use, since the dog drivers and handlers often cannot hear the countdown unless it is amplified.

Equipment with two speakers or "horns" is ideal, one speaker being directed into the holding area, the other toward the spectators.

CANCELLATIONS AND POSTPONEMENTS

Nothing is so detrimental to the sport of sled dog racing as an event run on such poor terrain, or poor conditions that dogs or drivers are injured, times drag on, all involved are depressed and the spectators drift away with an unhappy impression.

A race should be cancelled or postponed if drivers are unable to follow the trail or run on it due to weather conditions, lack of snow or other circumstances, including unexpected alterations in the course due to human factors. It is a major decision for the race giving club and should not be considered lightly.

The course should be inspected two or three days before the race and if conditions are found to be unfavorable, the decision should be made at that time and all entrants informed by telephone. A weather forecast may give hopes that snow will cover the area and if the club decides to hold the race on this basis, drivers should still be telephoned and warned of the circumstances and given the opportunity to withdraw their entry if they wish (with refund of entry fee).

There is no way to head off drivers who have already started for the race location when the disaster occurs in the form of blinding blizzard, thawing rainstorm, flood, etc. If the club has chosen an alternate course and can put on a deduced but endurable race in some location, it should do so.

If the race is postponed, the new date should be announced immediately. Inform the entrants on the telephone that a new date has been set and hope for the best. If a driver cannot make the new date, his entry fee should be returned.

Consultation with the sponsors should precede any decision of this kind. The sponsor may be willing to carry over the prize money to a later date in the same season. He may not be willing to hold the prize money until next year.

It is almost impossible to set any definite rules about when or why a race should be cancelled. A rule of thumb is, "Go ahead and run if the sponsors are willing and it will not endanger the drivers or dogs."

In some places, it may be possible to go ahead, when the snow has not appeared, and run the race with gigs or carts. This never should coming into consideration for an "open race" which expects to attract professional teams and drivers but is feasible for "strictly local club events." Naturally, all entrants should be telephoned and informed of this change in plan. There may be some drivers who will refuse to "race on wheels" as the competitive nature of a race and the more unweildy carts do not mix well in their opinion. In that case, entry fees should be returned.

In sections where the possibility of "no snow" always exists, all planning should allow for a good wheel race course and should be laid out well in advance of the race. A safe wheel course is a safe sled course... but not necessarily the other way around.

Be certain that your contract with the sponsor states clearly who makes the decision to cancel and what is to be done with money, trophies and properties obtained for the race.

